TABLES & HIGH-YIELD

# Ancient History

Teaching tables, Confused Pairs, Common Traps, Current Affairs, and other high-yield blocks.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

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# Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events

## Consolidated — 28 Must-Score Facts

1. Culture ladder: **Palaeolithic → Mesolithic → Neolithic → Chalcolithic → Iron Age / NBPW**.
2. Harappan: **Early c. 3300–2600 → Mature c. 2600–1900 → Late c. 1900–1300 BCE**.
3. Vedic: **Early / Rigvedic c. 1500–1000 → Later Vedic c. 1000–600 BCE**.
4. Religious founders (traditional coaching dates): **Mahavira c. 599–527 BCE**; **Buddha c. 563–483 BCE**.
5. Magadha dynasties: **Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya**.
6. Magadha kings: **Bimbisara → Ajatashatru** (Haryanka peak) → **Udayin** (Pataliputra capital) → **Shishunaga** (takes Avanti) → **Mahapadma / Dhana Nanda**.
7. **Alexander 326–325 BCE** (Hydaspes vs Porus; mutiny at Beas) → **Chandragupta Maurya c. 321 BCE**.
8. Maurya spine: **Chandragupta → Bindusara → Ashoka (c. 268–232) → decline → Pushyamitra Shunga 185 BCE**.
9. **Kalinga War c. 261 BCE** — Ashoka's turning point to Dhamma; **Third Council c. 250 BCE** at Pataliputra.
10. Post-Mauryan: **Shunga → Kanva**; Deccan **Satavahana**; NW **Indo-Greek → Shaka → Parthian → Kushana**.
11. Eras: **Vikrama 57 BCE**; **Saka 78 CE** (Kanishka-linked). Difference = **135 years**.
12. Kushana peak: **Kujula → Vima (gold) → Kanishka** (Fourth Council, Kashmir / Kundalvana tradition).
13. Gupta Era begins **c. 319–320 CE** with **Chandragupta I** (first *Maharajadhiraja*).
14. Gupta spine: **Chandragupta I → Samudragupta → Chandragupta II → Kumaragupta I → Skandagupta**.
15. Pilgrims: **Fa-Hien** under Chandragupta II (~399–414); **Xuanzang** under Harsha (~630–644); **I-tsing** after Harsha (~671–695).
16. Science tags: **Aryabhata** (born **476 CE**); **Varahamihira**; **Brahmagupta 628 CE**.
17. **Harsha 606–647 CE**; defeated on the Narmada by **Pulakeshin II** (Aihole / Ravikirti).
18. South spine: **Sangam → Satavahana → Pallava → Badami Chalukya → Rashtrakuta → Imperial Chola** (later = Medieval).
19. Do not swap **Fa-Hien / Xuanzang** or **Chandragupta Maurya / Chandragupta I / Chandragupta II**.
20. Do not swap **First Buddhist Council (Rajagriha)** with **Third (Pataliputra / Ashoka)** or **Fourth (Kanishka)**.
21. Pottery clock: **OCP → PGW → NBPW** sits beside the culture ladder for doab stems.
22. Invader order into NW India: **Greeks → Sakas → Kushans** (Parthians bridge Shaka and Kushan).
23. Seleucus–Chandragupta treaty **~305–303 BCE** (500 elephants; Megasthenes). Diadochi **Ipsus 301 BCE**.
24. Huna check: **Toramana → Mihirakula**; **Yashodharman** of Malwa at Mandasor **~532 CE**.
25. Harsha capitals: early **Thanesar** → later **Kannauj**; Chinese title **Siladitya**.
26. Sangam Muvendar: **Chera–Vanji**, **Chola–Uraiyur**, **Pandya–Madurai**; Karikala's **Kallanai**.
27. Key inscription pegs: **Hathigumpha** (Kharavela), **Junagadh** (Rudradaman), **Prayag Prashasti** (Samudragupta / Harishena), **Aihole** (Pulakeshin II).
28. UP chronological anchors: Belan Neolithic → Alamgirpur / Sanauli fringe → Later Vedic doab → UP mahajanapadas → Sarnath / Kushinagar → Mathura Kushan → Bhitari Skandagupta → Kannauj Harsha.

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Early Vedic | Later Vedic | Pastoral Rigvedic Jana vs territorial janapadas / iron | ऋग्वैदिक / उत्तर वैदिक |
| Mahavira | Buddha | 24th Jain Tirthankara vs Buddhism's founder | महावीर / बुद्ध |
| Chandragupta Maurya | Chandragupta I | Maurya founder vs Gupta dynasty starter | मौर्य / गुप्त |
| Fa-Hien | Xuanzang | Gupta-age pilgrim vs Harsha-age pilgrim | फाह्यान / ह्वेनसांग |

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vikrama Era 57 BCE | Saka Era 78 CE | Calendar eras often matched wrongly | विक्रम / शक |
| Kanishka | Samudragupta | Kushana emperor vs Gupta conqueror | कनिष्क / समुद्रगुप्त |
| Kalinga War | First Buddhist Council | Ashoka's war vs Ajatashatru-era council | कलिंग / प्रथम संगीति |

## A.0 Megaspine — memorise this first

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **c. 2600–1900 BCE** | Mature Harappan urban phase |
| **c. 1500–1000 BCE** | Early Vedic (Rigvedic) age |
| **c. 1000–600 BCE** | Later Vedic age |
| **c. 600 BCE** | Sixteen Mahajanapadas; Magadha rises |
| **c. 563 / 483 BCE** | Birth / Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha (traditional) |
| **326 BCE** | Alexander invades; Battle of the Hydaspes |
| **c. 321 BCE** | Chandragupta Maurya founds the Mauryan Empire |
| **c. 261 BCE** | Ashoka's Kalinga War |
| **185 BCE** | Pushyamitra Shunga ends Mauryan rule |
| **78 CE** | Beginning of the Saka Era |
| **c. 319–320 CE** | Beginning of the Gupta Era; Chandragupta I |
| **c. 375–415 CE** | Chandragupta II Vikramaditya; Fa-Hien visits |
| **606–647 CE** | Harshavardhana of Kannauj; Xuanzang visits |

## A.1 Prehistoric India

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **Palaeolithic** | Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic cultures; Soan Valley and Bhimbetka sequence in coaching maps |
| **Mesolithic** | Microlithic tools; hunting–gathering with early domestication at some sites; rock art continuity |
| **Neolithic** | Settled agriculture and pottery; Mehrgarh as the classic early farming settlement |
| **Chalcolithic** | Copper + stone cultures across the Deccan, Rajasthan and Gangetic fringe |
| **Iron Age / NBPW** | Spread of iron; Northern Black Polished Ware linked to second urbanisation and Magadha |

## A.2 Indus / Harappan Civilization

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **c. 3300–2600 BCE** | Early Harappan / regionalisation phase; early Indus script signs appear |
| **c. 2800 BCE** | Harappa and Mohenjo-daro grow into major urban centres in coaching timelines |
| **c. 2600–1900 BCE** | Mature Harappan — planned cities, baked brick, drainage, seals, craft specialisation, long-distance trade |
| **c. 1900–1300 BCE** | Late Harappan / decline and localisation; Cemetery H and related cultures |
| **Key sites** | Harappa, Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira, Lothal, Kalibangan, Rakhigarhi, Banawali — learn site↔feature matches separately in Topic 2 |

## A.3 Vedic Age

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **c. 1500–1000 BCE** | Early Vedic / Rigvedic age; pastoral Jana polity; composition of the Rigveda |
| **c. 1200–1000 BCE** | Kuru polity emerges as an important Later Vedic political centre in many reconstructions |
| **c. 1000–600 BCE** | Later Vedic age; expansion into the Ganga valley; territorial janapadas; varna order hardens |
| **c. 700–500 BCE** | Composition and teaching of major Upanishads; end of the classical Vedic period in broad keys |
| **c. 700 BCE** | Kosala and other eastern kingdoms strengthen within the Northern Black Polished Ware world |

## A.4 Mahajanapadas, Jainism & Buddhism

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **c. 600 BCE** | Sixteen Mahajanapadas listed in the Anguttara Nikaya; Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa and Avanti as the Big Four |
| **c. 599 BCE** | Traditional birth of Mahavira, 24th Tirthankara of Jainism |
| **c. 563 BCE** | Traditional birth of Siddhartha Gautama (the Buddha) at Lumbini |
| **c. 544–492 BCE** | Bimbisara of the Haryanka dynasty rules Magadha; contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira |
| **c. 527 BCE** | Traditional nirvana / moksha of Mahavira |
| **c. 492–460 BCE** | Ajatashatru rules Magadha; fortifies Rajagriha; conflicts with Vajji / Licchavi |
| **c. 483 BCE** | Traditional Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha at Kushinagar |
| **c. 483 BCE** | First Buddhist Council at Rajagriha under Ajatashatru |
| **c. 383 BCE** | Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali |
| **c. 413–345 BCE** | Shishunaga dynasty controls Magadha after the Haryankas |
| **c. 345–321 BCE** | Nanda dynasty under Mahapadma Nanda and Dhana Nanda — Magadha at peak before the Mauryas |
| **c. 350 BCE** | Panini of Gandhara composes the Ashtadhyayi — classical Sanskrit grammar |

## A.5 Alexander & the Mauryan Empire

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **327–326 BCE** | Alexander invades the north-west; Ambhi of Taxila submits |
| **326 BCE** | Battle of the Hydaspes — Alexander defeats Porus |
| **325–324 BCE** | Alexander retreats from the Beas; Macedonian hold in the north-west weakens |
| **c. 321 BCE** | Chandragupta Maurya overthrows the Nandas with Chanakya's help; capital at Pataliputra |
| **c. 305–303 BCE** | Chandragupta's war and treaty with Seleucus Nicator — north-west territories for elephants; Megasthenes later at Pataliputra |
| **c. 297–273 BCE** | Bindusara succeeds Chandragupta; Deccan expansion continues |
| **c. 273 / 268 BCE** | Ashoka ascends (coaching keys use either year; reign conventionally to c. 232 BCE) |
| **c. 261 BCE** | Kalinga War; Ashoka turns to Dhamma after the slaughter |
| **c. 260–250 BCE** | Ashokan Major and Minor Rock Edicts and Pillar Edicts; Buddhist missions; Third Buddhist Council tradition at Pataliputra |
| **c. 232 BCE** | Death of Ashoka; later Mauryas weaken |
| **c. 230 BCE** | Simuka founds the Satavahana power in the Deccan as Mauryan control fades |
| **185 BCE** | Pushyamitra Shunga kills Brihadratha and founds the Shunga dynasty — end of Mauryan rule |

## A.6 Post-Mauryan to Kushanas

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **185–73 BCE** | Shunga dynasty in the Gangetic heartland; Brahmanical patronage; conflict with Indo-Greeks |
| **c. 73–28 BCE** | Kanva dynasty briefly succeeds the Shungas |
| **c. 180–165 BCE** | Indo-Greek power in the north-west; Menander (Milinda) as the most famous Indo-Greek king |
| **57 BCE** | Beginning of the Vikrama Era (coaching calendar tag) |
| **c. 1st cent. BCE – 3rd cent. CE** | Satavahana Empire in the Deccan; conflict and exchange with the Shakas |
| **30 BCE / 1st cent. CE** | Early historic Tamilakam — Chera, Chola, Pandya; Sangam literature phase |
| **78 CE** | Beginning of the Saka Era |
| **c. 1st–3rd cent. CE** | Shaka Kshatrapas in western India; Kushana Empire from Central Asia into the plains |
| **c. 78 / 127 CE** | Kanishka's accession (date debated); Kushana zenith; Gandhara–Mathura art; Fourth Buddhist Council tradition |
| **c. 100 CE** | Charaka Samhita tradition — classical Ayurveda compilation associated with this era in coaching keys |

## A.7 Gupta Age

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **c. 240–280 CE** | Sri Gupta and early Guptas as local Magadha rulers |
| **c. 319–320 CE** | Chandragupta I; beginning of the Gupta Era; marriage alliance with the Licchavis |
| **c. 335–375 CE** | Samudragupta's conquests; Allahabad / Prayaga Prashasti of Harishena; Vincent Smith's "Indian Napoleon" tag |
| **c. 345 CE** | Mayurasharma founds the Kadamba kingdom at Banavasi |
| **c. 375–415 CE** | Chandragupta II Vikramaditya (विक्रमादित्य); defeat of western Shakas; court of the Navaratnas; age of **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) in coaching keys |
| **c. 399–414 CE** | Fa-Hien (Faxian) travels in Gupta India |
| **c. 415–455 CE** | Kumaragupta I; title Mahendraditya; Nalanda's early growth under Gupta patronage |
| **c. 455–467 CE** | Skandagupta faces the Hunas |
| **476 CE** | Birth of Aryabhata — Aryabhatiya; place-value and astronomical work |
| **c. 467–550 CE** | Later Guptas weaken; Huna pressure; regional break-up |
| **c. 528 CE** | Yashodharman and allied rulers defeat Mihirakula's Hunas at the Battle of Sondani |
| **c. 550 CE** | Imperial Gupta power effectively ends |

## A.8 Harsha & late ancient South

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **c. 550–606 CE** | Post-Gupta regional kingdoms; Rise of Pushyabhuti power at Thanesar |

| Year | Event |
|---|---|
| **606 CE** | Harshavardhana crowned; later rules from Kannauj |
| **c. 630–644 CE** | Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) travels in India; describes Harsha and Nalanda |
| **c. 634–637 CE** | Pulakeshin II of Badami Chalukyas checks Harsha on the Narmada |
| **628 CE** | Brahmagupta completes the Brahmasphutasiddhanta |
| **647 CE** | Death of Harsha; rapid fragmentation of north India — early medieval transition |
| **Pallavas** | Kanchipuram capital; Mahendravarman I and Narasimhavarman I; rock-cut to structural temples |
| **Badami Chalukyas** | Pulakeshin II's peak; conflict with Pallavas and Harsha |
| **c. 753 CE** | Dantidurga founds the Rashtrakuta kingdom of Manyakhet — counted with early medieval south |

## Practice Zone — Arrange / Chronology Drill

> **25 stems.** Prefer full year order in the answer.

## Common Traps

1. **Chandragupta Maurya = Chandragupta I** → different dynasties.
2. **Fa-Hien = Harsha** → Fa-Hien is Gupta-age; Xuanzang is Harsha-age.
3. **Alexander after Chandragupta** → Alexander **before** Mauryan foundation.
4. **Kanishka = Gupta** → Kushana, not Gupta.
5. **First Buddhist Council under Ashoka** → First is Rajagriha; Ashoka linked to the Third.
6. **Saka Era = 57 BCE** → **78 CE**; Vikrama is **57 BCE**.
7. **Kalinga War = 185 BCE** → **c. 261 BCE**; 185 is Mauryan end.

# Topic 1 — Stone Age (Prehistoric India)

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Correct | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Paleolithic | Neolithic | Chipped handaxe vs polished/ground axe | पुरापाषाण / नवपाषाण |
| Microlith | Handaxe | Mesolithic composite blade vs Lower Paleolithic biface | सूक्ष्म पाषाण / हाथ कुल्हाड़ी |
| Bagor | Sarai Nahar Rai | Mesolithic **domestication** (RJ) vs Mesolithic **burials** (UP) | बागोर / सराय नाहर राय |
| Mehrgarh | Koldihwa | Wheat/barley (Balochistan) vs rice (UP Belan) | मेहरगढ़ / कोलडिहवा |
| Burzahom | Chirand | Kashmir **pit dwellings** vs Bihar **bone tools** | बुरज़होम / चिरांद |
| Rock shelter | Carved cave | Natural overhang (Bhimbetka) vs cut cave (Ajanta) | शैल आश्रय / कृत्रिम गुफा |
| Chalcolithic | Harappan | Rural copper+stone vs urban bronze/planned cities | ताम्रपाषाण / हड़प्पा |
| Hathnora fossil | Attirampakkam | *Homo erectus* skull vs old **tools** (no fossil) | हथनौरा / अत्तिरमपाक्कम |
| Wakankar | Sankalia | Bhimbetka discoverer vs Langhnaj/Deccan pioneer | वाकणकर / सांकलिया |
| OCP | Harappan ware | Doab ochre pottery (Chalcolithic) vs Indus urban pottery | गेरूआ मृद्भांड |
| **Soanian** | **Acheulian** | NW pebble/chopper (Soan–Siwalik) vs peninsular handaxe-cleaver | सोहन / ऐशूलियन |
| **Baghor** | **Bagor** | Upper Pal shrine, **Son valley MP** vs Meso domestication, **Rajasthan** | बाघोर / बागोर |
| Non-geometric microlith | Geometric microlith | Earlier Meso (backed blades) vs later Meso (lunate/triangle/trapeze) | अज्यामितीय / ज्यामितीय |
| Aceramic Neolithic | Ceramic Neolithic | Mehrgarh Period I (no pottery) vs later pottery levels | बिना मृद्भांड / मृद्भांड युक्त |
| Prehistoric | Proto-historic | No writing vs undeciphered script (e.g. Indus / Copper Age) | प्रागैतिहासिक / आद्यऐतिहासिक |
| Damdama triple burial | Sarai Nahar Rai four-skeleton grave | One triple grave at Damdama vs four skeletons in one grave at Sarai Nahar Rai | दमदमा / सराय नाहर राय |
| Lahuradewa | Mehrgarh | Early Ganga rice (Sant Kabir Nagar) vs NW wheat–barley village (Balochistan) | लहुरादेवा / मेहरगढ़ |

## 1.2 Stone Age

| Period | Approx. (India) | Economy | Defining fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Paleolithic** | ~2 mya – 10,000 BCE | Hunting and gathering | Chipped stone (core, flake, blade) |
| **Mesolithic** | ~10,000 – 4000 BCE | Hunting, fishing; some sedentism | **Microliths** |
| **Neolithic** | ~7000 – 1000 BCE | Food production | Ground or polished stone, pottery, villages |

| Period | Approx. (India) | Economy | Defining fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Chalcolithic** | ~3000 – 1000 BCE | Farming villages plus first metal | **Copper plus stone**; rural, not Harappan cities |

| Tool class | What it is | Typical period |
|---|---|---|
| **Chopper / chopping** | Pebble tool, one or both edges flaked | Lower Pal **Soanian** |
| **Handaxe / cleaver** | Bifacial core tool (Acheulian) | **Lower Paleolithic** |
| **Flake** | Struck from prepared core (Levallois) | **Middle Paleolithic** |

| Tool class | What it is | Typical period |
|---|---|---|
| **Blade / burin / scraper** | Long parallel-sided flake | **Upper Paleolithic** |
| **Microlith** | 1–8 cm composite blade | **Mesolithic** |
| **Celt / ground axe, quern** | Polished/ground stone | **Neolithic** |

## 1.3 Paleolithic Age

| Sub-period | Approx. | Tools (booklet triad) |
|---|---|---|
| **Lower** | ~2 mya – 100,000 BP | **Handaxe, cleaver, chopper** — Acheulian / Soanian cores |
| **Middle** | ~100,000 – 35,000 BP | **Points, borers, scrapers**; flake / Levallois |
| **Upper** | ~35,000 – 10,000 BP | **Burins** with blades and scrapers; bone tools; ostrich-eggshell beads |
| Lower Pal tradition | Zone | Fact |
| --- | --- | --- |
| **Soanian** | Soan–Siwalik (Punjab/Pakistan) | Pebble **chopper-chopping**; Yale–Cambridge team under **H. De Terra** (with Paterson), **1935** |
| **Acheulian** (also called **Madrasian** in older books) | Peninsula + Narmada + Kortallayar | **Handaxe-cleaver**; Foote at **Pallavaram** and **Attirampakkam** |

## 1.5 Neolithic Age

| Region | Crop / trait |
|---|---|
| Northwest (Mehrgarh) | **Wheat, barley** |
| Eastern UP / Belan | **Rice** (Koldihwa, Mahagara) |
| Ganga plain (Lahuradewa) | Early **rice** (lake-edge; not Belan) |
| South India | **Millets**; **ash-mound** pastoral sites |
| Kashmir | Pit dwellings; fishing/hunting heavy (Burzahom, Gufkral) |

## 1.11 Cave Paintings

| Colour | Pigment | Typical use (Bhimbetka rule of thumb) |
|---|---|---|
| **Red** | Haematite / ochre | Animals |
| **White** | Limestone / kaolin | Human figures, dancers |
| **Green** | Chromium minerals | Less common |
| **Black** | Manganese / charcoal | Occasional |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Wakankar vs Sankalia vs Vatsa** → Bhimbetka = **Wakankar 1957–58**; Sankalia = Langhnaj/Navdatoli; Vatsa = **Harappan**.
2. **Bagor vs Sarai Nahar Rai vs Bori** → Bagor = **domestication (RJ)**; SNR = **burials (UP)**; Bori = Paleolithic distractor.
3. **Baghor = Bagor** → Baghor = **Upper Pal, Son valley MP**; Bagor = **Meso Rajasthan**.

4. **Mehrgarh = rice / in India / Harappan / no farming because aceramic** → Wheat-barley + cotton, **Balochistan**, **pre-urban**; aceramic = no **pottery**.
5. **Burzahom / Chirand / Koldihwa swap** → Kashmir **pits**; Bihar **bone**; Belan **rice**. Cattle pen = **Mahagara**, not pits.
6. **Polished axe = Paleolithic** → **Neolithic**. Handaxe = **Lower Paleolithic / Acheulian**.
7. **Soanian = Acheulian handaxe** → Soanian = **pebble chopper** (Siwalik); Acheulian = **handaxe-cleaver**.
8. **Microlith = Paleolithic / Chalcolithic** → **Mesolithic** composite blade.
9. **All Bhimbetka art is Paleolithic / found in 2003** → Art mostly Meso+; discovery **1957–58**; UNESCO **2003**. **Raisen, Vindhyan**, not Satpura/KA.
10. **Rock shelter = Ajanta / Lakhudiyar = Bhimbetka** → Shelter = **natural**; Ajanta = **carved**; Lakhudiyar = **Uttarakhand**.
11. **Chalcolithic = Harappan cities / Gungeria = dock** → Rural copper+stone; OCP = **doab**; Gungeria = **Copper Hoard, MP**.
12. **Hathnora = sapiens / found by Wakankar** → ***Homo erectus***, **Sonakia 1982**. Attirampakkam = **tools**, Kortallayar TN.
13. **Inamgaon / Jorwe in Rajasthan** → **Maharashtra**. Ahar = Rajasthan. Navdatoli = **Narmada/Malwa**.
14. **Lahuradewa = Koldihwa / Belan** → Lahuradewa = **Sant Kabir Nagar**; Belan = Mirzapur–Prayagraj.
15. **Ash mounds = Gangetic / wild rice at SNR = cultivation** → Ash mounds = **South India**; SNR wild rice = Meso **gathering**.

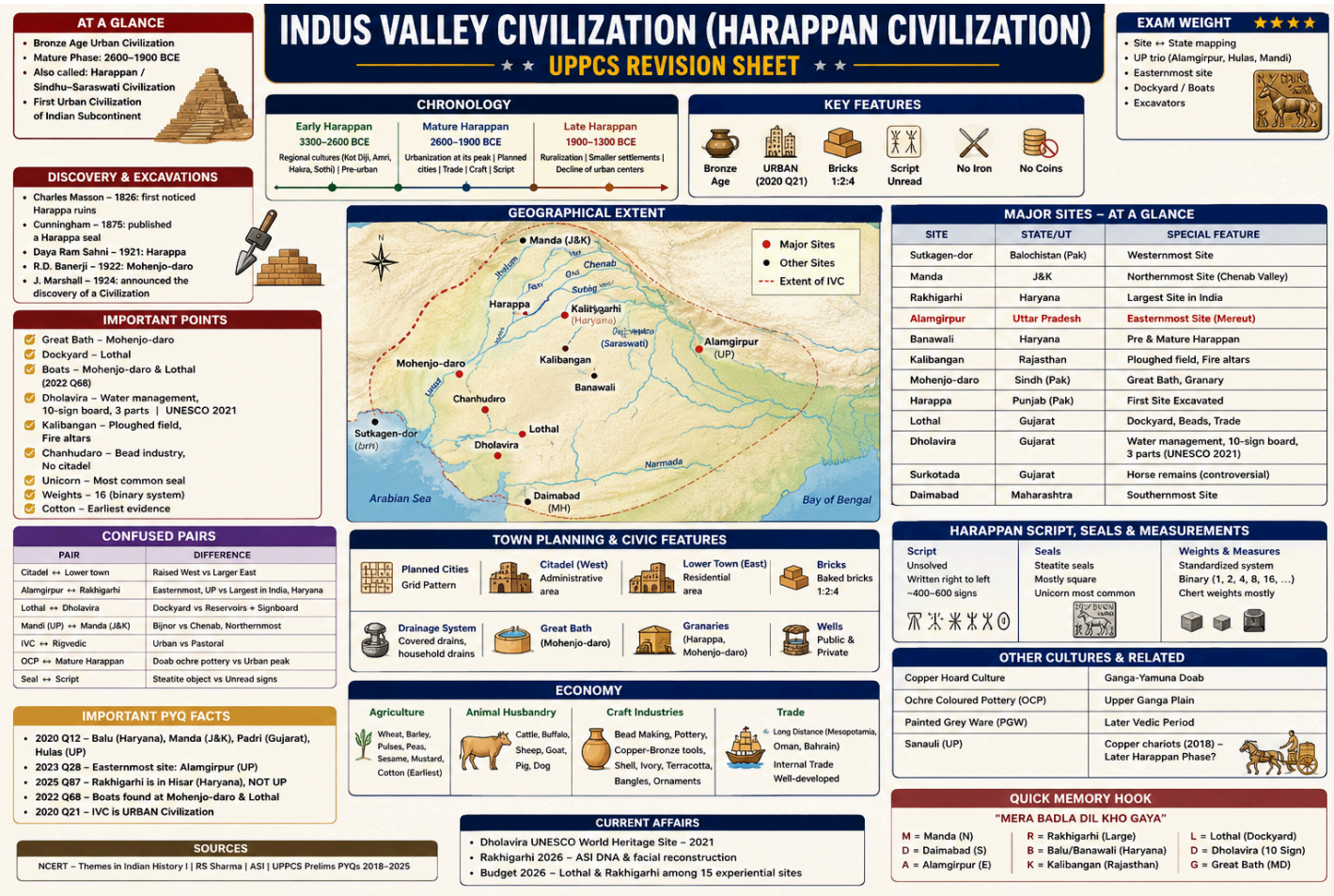
# Topic 2 — Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)

## Current Affairs

- **2021:** Dholavira → UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- **2018:** Sanauli chariot burials (ASI).
- **2026:** Rakhigarhi skeletons to AnSI (Kolkata) and BSIP Lucknow for DNA / facial reconstruction; ASI 3-year excavation.
- **Budget 2026:** 15 archaeological sites as experiential destinations, including **Lothal** and **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी).

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Harappan | Indus Valley | Same culture; named after first site **Harappa** | हड़प्पा / सिंधु घाटी |
| Citadel | Lower town | Raised **west** platform vs larger **east** residential zone | दुर्ग / निम्न नगर |
| Alamgirpur | Rakhigarhi | **Easternmost, UP** vs **largest in India, Haryana** | आलमगीरपुर / राखीगढ़ी |
| Lothal | Dholavira | **Dockyard** vs **reservoirs + signboard** | लोथल / धोलावीरा |
| Mandi (UP) | Manda (J&K) | **Muzaffarnagar** vs **Chenab, northernmost** | मंडी / मांडा |
| IVC | Rigvedic | **Urban** vs **pastoral** | नगरीय / पशुपालक |
| OCP | Mature Harappan | Doab ochre pottery vs urban peak | गेरूआ मृद्भांड |
| Seal | Script | Steatite object vs unread signs on it | मुद्रा / लिपि |
| Proto-historic | Historic | Undeciphered Harappan script vs usable written history (~6th c. BCE) | आद्यऐतिहासिक / ऐतिहासिक |
| Cemetery R-37 | Cemetery H | Mature Harappa coffin cemetery vs Late Harappan urn / fractional burial | आर-37 / सीमेट्री एच |
| Cow on seals | Unicorn / bull on seals | Cow **absent** vs common seal animals | गाय / एकशृंगी–वृषभ |
| Sohgaura | Chanhudaro | Mauryan copper-plate village (Gorakhpur) vs Harappan craft town (Sindh) | सोहगौरा / चन्हूदड़ो |




## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Rakhigarhi in UP / eastern boundary** → **Hisar, Haryana**; east = **Alamgirpur**.
2. **Mandi = Manda** → Mandi = **Muzaffarnagar, UP**; Manda = **J&K**, northernmost.
3. **Lothal = Dholavira** → Lothal = **dockyard**; Dholavira = **water + signboard** (UNESCO 2021).
4. **Boat models at Dholavira** → **Mohenjo-daro + Lothal** (2022).
5. **Kalibangan / Lothal in UP** → Rajasthan / Gujarat (2018).
6. **IVC = pastoral** → **Urban**; pastoral = **Rigvedic**.
7. **Wheeler discovered IVC** → Sahni **1921**, Banerji **1922**, Marshall **1924**.
8. **Great Bath at Harappa / Dholavira** → **Mohenjo-daro only**.
9. **Iron / coins / decoded Sanskrit script** → all **false**.
10. **Horse is definite** → only **Surkotada**, and **disputed**.
11. **Chanhudaro = citadel city** → bead town, **no citadel**.
12. **OCP = Mature Harappan grid** → doab ochre pottery.
13. **Sanauli = Great Bath city** → Baghpat **chariots**, Late Harappan/OCP.
14. **Balu = UP / Padri = Haryana** → Balu = **Haryana**, Padri = **Gujarat**, Hulas = **UP**.
15. **Daimabad in Gujarat** → **Maharashtra**; bronzes ≠ Sanauli chariots.

# Topic 3 — Vedic Civilization

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rigvedic | Later Vedic | **Pastoral**, Punjab, assemblies strong vs **agrarian**, doab, king strong | ऋग्वेदिक / उत्तर वैदिक |
| Sabha | Samiti | Elders/nobles (later exclusive) vs **general tribal** assembly that **chooses the rajan** | सभा / समिति |
| Sabha | Vidatha | Political/judicial elite vs **oldest** gathering — **economic + ritual**, women, **fades first** | सभा / विदथ |
| Bhagadugha | Sangrahitri | Collects king's **share (bhaga)** vs **treasurer** | भागदुघ / संग्रहीतृ |
| Bhagadugha | Akshavapa | Revenue vs **dice / gambling** officer | भागदुघ / अक्षावाप |
| Shukla Yajurveda | Krishna Yajurveda | **Vajasaneyi** (mantra & prose separate) vs Taittiriya / Kathaka / Maitrayani (mixed). **Krishna here = Black Yajurveda**, not the god Krishna | शुक्ल / कृष्ण यजुर्वेद |
| Indra | Agni | **~250** hymns, war/rain vs **~200** hymns, fire / offering-carrier | इन्द्र / अग्नि |
| Indra (Early) | Prajapati (Later) | War-chief god of Rigveda vs creator / ritual supreme of Later Vedic | इन्द्र / प्रजापति |
| Vishnu (RV) | Vishnu (Later) | **Minor** in Rigveda vs rises with Rudra in Later Vedic / Upanishadic age | ऋग्वेद विष्णु / उत्तर वैदिक विष्णु |
| Samhita | Brahmana | Hymns/mantras vs **prose ritual** explanation | संहिता / ब्राह्मण |
| Aranyaka | Upanishad | Forest **symbolic ritual** vs **Brahman–Atman** philosophy | आरण्यक / उपनिषद् |
| Varna | Jati | Four-fold (Purusha Sukta; rigid later) vs birth-group (post-Vedic) | वर्ण / जाति |
| Gavishti | Bali | Cattle-raid / war vs **tribute** to the king | गविष्टि / बलि |
| Nishka | Coin | Gold **ornament / value-unit** vs coined money (**absent**) | निष्क / मुद्रा |
| Shruti | Smriti | Heard (Veda corpus) vs remembered (later dharma texts) | श्रुति / स्मृति |
| Vedanga | Upanishad | Six **limbs** (tools) vs **Vedanta** (end of Veda) | वेदांग / उपनिषद् |
| PGW | NBPW | Later Vedic **grey painted** doab ware vs mahajanapada **black polished** elite ware | चित्रित धूसर / उत्तरी काली |
| PGW | OCP | Iron-age **painted grey** vs pre-PGW **ochre-wash** doab rural | PGW / OCP |
| shyama ayas | ayas (Rigveda) | Later Vedic **iron** vs Early Vedic **copper/bronze** | श्याम आयस / आयस |
| Trayi | Atharvaveda | Rig–Yajur–Sama liturgical trio vs fourth Veda of charms / household | त्रयी / अथर्ववेद |
| Karma-kanda | Jnana-kanda | Samhita + Brahmana ritual vs Aranyaka + Upanishad philosophy | कर्मकांड / ज्ञानकांड |
| Aghanya | Horse sacrifice | Cow "not to be killed" vs Ashvamedha horse rite | अघन्या / अश्वमेध |
| Sindhu (most named) | Saraswati (most sacred) | Frequency in hymns vs *Naditama* piety | सिन्धु / सरस्वती |

## Books and Writers — Vedic Age

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Ashtadhyayi* (अष्टाध्यायी) | **Panini** (पाणिनि) | Vyakarana; Classical Sanskrit grammar |
| *Nirukta* (निरुक्त) | **Yaska** (यास्क) | Etymology Vedanga |
| Chhanda / metre tradition | **Pingala** | Metre Vedanga |

## 3.4 Vedic Administration

| Ratnin (jewel-officer) | Role |
|---|---|
| **Purohita** | Chief priest and royal adviser |
| **Senani** | Army commander |
| **Gramani** | Village head |
| **Suta** | Charioteer / court bard |
| **Kshattri** | Chamberlain-type officer |
| **Bhagadugha** | Revenue collector of the king's **bhaga** |
| **Sangrahitri** | Treasurer |
| **Akshavapa** | Dice / gambling officer |
| **Takshan** | Carpenter |
| **Govikartana** | Cowherd / cattle officer in lists |
| **Palagala** | Another ratnin name in Later Vedic lists |

## Rigvedic vs Later Vedic — Comparison Framework

| Point | Rigvedic | Later Vedic |
|---|---|---|
| Territory | **Sapta Sindhu** (Punjab) | **Ganga–Yamuna doab** and beyond |
| Economy | **Pastoral** (cattle wealth) | **Agrarian** (iron plough, surplus) |
| Polity | elected **rajan** + strong Sabha–Samiti–Vidatha | hereditary **raja**; weaker assemblies |
| Society | flexible occupation; women freer | rigid **varna**; women lose ground |
| Religion | nature gods; **Indra** tops hymns | ritual kings' yajnas; **Prajapati / Vishnu / Rudra** rise |
| Archaeology | no cities; **ayas** = copper/bronze | **PGW** + **iron** (*shyama ayas*) |

## Vedic Religion and Ritual

### Rigvedic gods and hymn counts

| God | Approx. Rigvedic hymns | Role / fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Indra** | **~250** (largest) | War god, rain-bringer, slayer of **Vritra**; called **Purandara** (fort-breaker) |
| **Agni** | **~200** (second) | Fire god; carries offerings to other gods |
| **Soma** | **~120** | Ritual drink-god; Mandala **IX** is the Soma book |
| **Ashvins** | **~50+** | Twin healer / dawn horsemen gods |
| **Varuna** | fewer (but high prestige) | Guardian of **rita** (cosmic / moral order) |
| **Mitra** (मित्र -) | paired with Varuna | Treaty / friendship; often **Mitra–Varuna** |
| **Maruts** | storm band with Indra | Wind / storm companions |
| **Ushas** | dawn hymns | Dawn goddess |
| **Savitr** | solar | Invoked in the **Gayatri** (RV III.62.10) |
| **Surya / Pushan** | solar group | Sun and path / cattle-path gods |
| **Vishnu** | few / **minor** | Three strides myth; **not** yet supreme |

| God | Approx. Rigvedic hymns | Role / fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Rudra** | few / **minor** | Fierce storm / healer; later rises as Shiva |

## 3.11 Four Vedas

| Veda | Core content | Priest | Upaveda | Main Samhita(s) | Key Brahmana(s) | Structure fact |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Rigveda** | Oldest; hymns (*rik*) | **Hotri / Hota** | **Ayurveda** (often also linked Atharva) | Rigveda Samhita | **Aitareya**, Kausitaki | **1028** hymns; **~10552** verses (*richas*); **10** mandalas |
| **Samaveda** (सामवेद) | Melodies (*saman*) for Soma | **Udgatri** | **Gandharvaveda** | Samaveda Samhita (mostly from Rig) | Tandya / Panchavimsha, Jaiminiya | Chant-book for sacrifice |
| **Yajurveda** (यजुर्वेद) | Sacrificial formulas (*yajus*) | **Adhvaryu** | **Dhanurveda** | **Shukla:Vajasaneyi** (Madhyandina, Kanva; paper: **Vajasanami**). **Krishna:** Taittiriya, Kathaka, Maitrayani (+ Kapishthala) | **Shatapatha** (Shukla, **100** ch.); Taittiriya (Krishna) | Shukla = mantra & Brahmana **apart**; Krishna = **mixed** |
| **Atharvaveda** | Spells, healing, household | **Brahman** (rite supervisor) | **Arthashastra** (अर्थशास्त्र) | Atharvaveda Samhita | **Gopatha** (only one) | **20** books; newest of the four; early **iron** hints |

## 3.12 Brahmanas

| Brahmana | Veda |
|---|---|
| Aitareya, Kausitaki (Shankhayana) | Rigveda |
| Tandya / Panchavimsha, Jaiminiya | Samaveda |
| **Shatapatha** (largest, **100** chapters) | **Shukla Yajurveda** |
| Taittiriya | Krishna Yajurveda |
| **Gopatha** (only one) | Atharvaveda |

## 3.15 Vedangas and Six Systems of Philosophy (Shad-Darshana)

| Vedanga | Job | Fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Shiksha** | Phonetics | Pratishakhya texts |
| **Kalpa** | Ritual sutras | **Shrauta** (public), **Grihya** (domestic), **Dharma** (law), **Sulba** (altar geometry — Baudhayana, Apastamba) |
| **Vyakarana** | Grammar | **Panini**, *Ashtadhyayi* (~5th c. BCE, edge of / just after Vedic) |
| **Nirukta** | Etymology | **Yaska** |
| **Chhanda** | Metre | **Pingala** |
| **Jyotisha** | Ritual calendar / astronomy | Vedanga Jyotisha |

## 3.17 Iron Age in India

| Region | Iron Age marker | Period fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Northwest / doab** | PGW then NBPW | Later Vedic → mahajanapada |
| **South / Deccan** | Megaliths + black-and-red ware | Pre-Sangam bed |
| **Chalcolithic overlap** | Limited copper before iron | Mehrgarh, Jorwe, OCP zones |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Detail |
|---|---|
| Later Vedic **core** | **Ganga–Yamuna doab** — western–central UP |
| **Kuru** | Delhi–Haryana–Meerut belt; Hastinapur tradition |
| **Panchala** | Rohilkhand–central doab (Ahichchhatra near Bareilly) |
| **Kosala** | Eastern UP (later Ayodhya / Shravasti world) |
| **Kashi** | Varanasi |
| **Videha** | North Bihar (Janaka) — east of UP, linked in Shatapatha |
| PGW sites | **Hastinapur** (Meerut), **Atranjikhera** (Etah), **Ahichchhatra**, Noh (Rajasthan) |
| Rigvedic | **Not** a UP heartland — Punjab / Sapta Sindhu |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Rigvedic = agrarian / urban** → **Pastoral**; urban = IVC; agrarian = Later Vedic (2020).
2. **Bhagadugha = gambling / forest / messenger** → **Revenue**; gambling = **Akshavapa** (2023 C).
3. **Taittiriya / Maitrayani / Kathak = Shukla** → all **Krishna (Black)** Yajurveda; Shukla = **Vajasaneyi** (2018). **Krishna ≠ deity Krishna**.
4. **Sabha = Samiti = Vidatha** → elders vs tribe vs oldest ritual-share gathering.
5. **Vedic Sabha = Gram Sabha / Rajya Sabha** → zero link.
6. **Nishka = coin** → gold **ornament**.
7. **Purusha Sukta = oldest hymn** → Mandala **X**, late.
8. **Upanishad = Vedanga** → Shruti / Vedanta, not a limb.
9. **Iron plough in Rigveda** → **Later Vedic**; RV ayas = copper/bronze.
10. **Women's status same throughout** → falls in **Later Vedic**.
11. **Gayatri = Atharvaveda** → RV **III.62.10**.
12. **Aitareya Brahmana = Samaveda** → **Rigveda**; Shatapatha = **Shukla Yajurveda**.
13. **Vidatha still powerful in Later Vedic** → **first to fade**.
14. **Alamgirpur = Vedic Videha** → **Harappan** east end (Meerut belt).
15. **Sayana = Vedic rishi** → **14th century** commentator.
16. **PGW = Sangam south / NBPW** → PGW = **Later Vedic doab**; NBPW = mahajanapada cities (Topic 5).
17. **Megalithic = PGW** → megaliths = **south/Deccan** Iron Age; PGW = **northwest doab**.
18. **Iron in Rigveda = shyama ayas** → RV **ayas** = copper/bronze; iron = **Later Vedic**.
19. **Indra hymns unknown / Vishnu tops RV** → Indra **~250**, Agni **~200**, Soma **~120**; Vishnu **minor** in Rigveda.
20. **Krishna Yajurveda = Krishna-bhakti text** → Black Yajurveda school (mixed mantra–prose).

# Topic 4 — Religious Movements

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shramana | Brahmana | Renouncer, often **nastika** vs Vedic priestly orthodoxy | श्रमण / ब्राह्मण |
| Nastika | Astika | Reject Veda (Buddha, Jina, Ajivika, Charvaka) vs accept Veda | नास्तिक / आस्तिक |
| Four Noble Truths | Eightfold Path | Diagnosis of dukkha vs the **Magga** prescription | चार आर्य सत्य / अष्टांग मार्ग |
| Hinayana | Mahayana | **Arhat**, Pali, self-liberation vs **bodhisattva**, Sanskrit | हीनयान / महायान |
| Mahayana | Vajrayana | Sutra / emptiness vs **tantra**, mantra, Tibet | महायान / वज्रयान |
| Sthaviravada | Mahasanghika | Vaishali **elders** vs **great assembly** split | स्थविर / महासंघ |
| Theravada | Sarvastivada | **Pali** south-Asian line vs **Sanskrit** north line (4th Council) | थेरवाद / सर्वास्तिवाद |
| Mahasanghika | Mahayana | Vaishali **early split** school vs later **great vehicle** | महासंघ / महायान |
| Vaibhashika | Sautrantika | Sarvastivada **Abhidharma** orthodox vs **sutra-only** | वैभाषिक / सौत्रान्तिक |
| Nagarjuna | Nagasena | **Madhyamaka** philosopher vs **Milinda Panha** monk | नागार्जुन / नागसेन |
| Vinaya | Sutta | Monk **rules** vs Buddha's **discourses** | विनय / सुत्त |
| Chaitya | Vihara | Prayer hall vs monastery | चैत्य / विहार |
| Barabar | Ajanta | Mauryan, **Ajivika** gift vs later **Buddhist** painted caves | बराबर / अजंता |
| Digambara | Svetambara | Sky-clad; women no moksha as women vs white-clad; women can | दिगंबर / श्वेतांबर |
| Mahavira | Parshvanatha | 24th, **5** vows, **lion**, Pavapuri vs 23rd, **4** vows, **serpent** | महावीर / पार्श्वनाथ |
| Pavapuri | Sammed Shikhar | **Mahavira** only vs **20** tirthankaras (not Vasupujya) | पावापुरी / सम्मेद शिखर |
| Charvaka | Ajivika | Materialist, pratyaksha-only vs **fatalist niyati** | चार्वाक / आजीविक |
| Shaivism | Vaishnavism | Shiva / linga vs Vishnu / avatars | शैव / वैष्णव |
| Bhagavatism | Vaishnavism | Early **Vasudeva-Krishna** cult vs later full Vishnu tradition | भागवत / वैष्णव |
| Anekantavada | Syadvada | Many-sided **reality** vs seven-fold **predication** ("syat") | अनेकान्तवाद / स्याद्वाद |
| Anatta | Jiva | Buddhism: **no** permanent soul vs Jainism: **real** soul | अनात्मा / जीव |
| Pataliputra (Jain) | Vallabhi | Early Magadhan compilation / Sthulabhadra vs **final Svetambara canon** | पाटलिपुत्र / वल्लभी |

## Books and Writers — Religious Movements

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Milinda Panha* | **Menander (Milinda)** and **Nagasena** | Indo-Greek Buddhist dialogue |
| *Buddha Charita* (*Buddhacharita*) (बुद्धचरित) | **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) | Sanskrit Buddha-life; Kanishka age |
| *Saundarananda* (सौंदरानंद) | **Ashvaghosha** | Same court circle |
| *Madhyamaka Karika* | **Nagarjuna** | Madhyamaka / sunyata |
| *Visuddhimagga* | **Buddhaghosa** | Theravada manual |
| *Mahavibhasha* | Fourth Council circle (**Vasumitra**; Ashvaghosha age) | Sarvastivada; Kashmir / Kanishka |

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Tattvartha Sutra* | **Umasvati** | Jain; accepted by Digambara and Svetambara |
| *Kalpasutra* | **Bhadrabahu** | Tirthankara lives; Paryushana reading |
| *Parishishtaparvan* | **Hemachandra** | Later Jain narrative |

## 4.2 Buddha

| Event | Place | Age / fact | Art symbol |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Birth** | **Lumbini** (Nepal) | Ashokan **Rummindei** pillar marks the site | **Lotus** and **bull** |
| **Mahabhinishkramana** | Kapilavastu departure | Age **29**; horse **Kanthaka**, charioteer **Channa** | **Horse** |
| **Enlightenment** | **Bodh Gaya** (Bihar) | ~35; under Bodhi tree at Uruvela on Niranjana (Falgu) river after accepting milk-rice from Sujata | **Bodhi / peepal tree** |
| **First sermon** | **Sarnath / Isipatana** (UP) | Deer Park; delivered to 5 disciples (Kaundinya, Bhaddiya, Vappa, Mahanama, Assaji) | **Wheel** (often with deer) |
| **Mahaparinirvana** | **Kushinagar** (UP) | Age 80 (483 BC) at Kasia village; Malla republic; between sala trees | **Stupa** |

## 4.3 Four Noble Truths

| # | Pali name | Meaning | Key fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Dukkha** | Suffering / unsatisfactoriness | Does **not** mean "life is only pain" |
| 2 | **Samudaya** | Cause of suffering | **Tanha / trishna** (craving), fed by **avidya** (ignorance) |
| 3 | **Nirodha** | Cessation of suffering | Craving **can** stop; that stop is **nirvana** |
| 4 | **Magga** | Path to cessation | Names the **Eightfold Path** as the cure |

## 4.4 Eightfold Path

| Group | Path factor | Sanskrit / Pali fact | What it means |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Prajna** (wisdom) | Right View | *samyag-drishti* | See the Four Noble Truths correctly |
| **Prajna** (wisdom) | Right Resolve | *samyak-sankalpa* | Right intention and renunciation |
| **Sila** (conduct) | Right Speech | *samyag-vac* | No lying, abuse, or idle harm |
| **Sila** (conduct) | Right Action | *samyak-karmanta* | Moral bodily conduct |
| **Sila** (conduct) | Right Livelihood | *samyag-ajiva* | Earn without harm |
| **Samadhi** (समाधि) (concentration) | Right Effort | *samyag-vyayama* | Train the mind and restrain unwholesome states |
| **Samadhi** (concentration) | Right Mindfulness | *samyak-smriti* | Constant awareness |
| **Samadhi** (concentration) | Right Concentration | *samyak-samadhi* | Meditative absorption |

## 4.5 Buddhist Philosophy

### Three marks and five skandhas

| Mark / bundle | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Anicca** | All conditioned things are impermanent |
| **Dukkha** | Unsatisfactoriness follows from impermanence |
| **Anatta** | There is **no permanent self** — split from Jain **jiva** and Upanishadic **atman** |
| Skandha | Sanskrit |
| --- | --- |
| Form | **Rupa** |
| Feeling | **Vedana** |
| Perception | **Samjna** |
| Formations | **Samskara** |
| Consciousness | **Vijnana** |

### Dependent arising (Pratityasamutpada)

| # | Nidana | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Avidya** | Ignorance |
| 2 | **Samskara** | Volitional formations |
| 3 | **Vijnana** | Consciousness |
| 4 | **Namarupa** | Name and form |
| 5 | **Sadayatana** | Six sense bases |
| 6 | **Sparsha** | Contact |
| 7 | **Vedana** | Feeling |
| 8 | **Trishna** | Craving |
| 9 | **Upadana** | Clinging |
| 10 | **Bhava** (भाव) | Becoming |
| 11 | **Jati** (जाति) | Birth |
| 12 | **Jara-marana** | Old age and death |

## 4.6 Buddhist Councils

### Place order (highest-yield spine)

| # | Place | Patron / ruler | President | Main outcome |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1st** (~483 BCE) | **Rajagriha** (Sattapanni / Saptaparni cave) | **Ajatashatru** (अजातशत्रु) (Magadha) | **Mahakassapa** | **Upali** recited **Vinaya**; **Ananda** recited **Suttas** |
| **2nd** (~383 BCE) | **Vaishali** | **Kalashoka** | **Sabakami / Sabbakami** | Ten-point **Vinaya** dispute; split into **Sthaviravada** (elders) and **Mahasanghika** (great assembly) |
| **3rd** (**c. 250 / 247 BCE**) | **Pataliputra** | **Ashoka** (अशोक) | **Moggaliputta Tissa** | **Vibhajjavada** line wins; **Abhidhamma** and *Kathavatthu*; missions to Sri Lanka (**Mahinda**, **Sanghamitta**) |

| # | Place | Patron / ruler | President | Main outcome |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **4th** (north-Indian list) | **Kundalvana**, Kashmir | **Kanishka** (कनिष्क) | **Vasumitra** (+ **Ashvaghosha** as deputy) | **Sarvastivada** school; **Sanskrit** turn; *Mahavibhasha*; Mahayana gains Kushan patronage; Buddha elevated as deity in Mahayana framing |

## 4.7 Buddhist Texts

| Text | Fact |
|---|---|
| ***Milinda Panha*** | Dialogue of Indo-Greek **Menander (Milinda)** and monk **Nagasena** |
| ***Jataka*** | 547 stories of Buddha's previous births; in Khuddaka Nikaya |
| ***Dhammapada*** | Verse ethics; in Khuddaka Nikaya |
| ***Buddha Charita* (*Buddhacharita*)** | Sanskrit Buddha-life by **Ashvaghosha** (Kanishka age); also wrote *Saundarananda* |
| ***Mahavastu***, ***Lalitavistara***, ***Divyavadana*** | Narrative Sanskrit Buddha lives |
| ***Prajnaparamita***, ***Lotus Sutra***, ***Lankavatara*** | Key Mahayana sutras |
| ***Dipavamsa***, ***Mahavamsa*** | Sri Lankan chronicles |
| ***Visuddhimagga*** | Buddhaghosa's Theravada manual |

## 4.8 Tripitaka

| Pitaka | Content | Traditional reciter | Key fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Vinaya** | Monastic rules — Suttavibhanga, Khandhaka, Parivara | **Upali** | Sangha **law** |
| **Sutta** | Buddha's discourses — five nikayas (Digha, Majjhima, Samyutta, Anguttara, **Khuddaka**) | **Ananda** | **Dhammapada** and **Jataka** (547 stories) in Khuddaka |
| **Abhidhamma** | Scholastic analysis and lists | — | Tied to **Third Council** in Theravada memory; seven books include **Yamaka**, *Patthana*, *Kathavatthu*, *Puggalapannatti*, *Dhatukatha*, *Vibhanga*, *Dhammasangani* |

## 4.9 Hinayana

### Main early schools you must know

| School | Origin / link | Doctrine or practice | Region / canon |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Sthaviravada** | Elders' side at **Vaishali** (2nd Council) | Orthodox Vinaya; parent line of later Hinayana schools | Ancestor school — not identical with Theravada |
| **Mahasanghika** | Liberal side at **Vaishali** | More relaxed monastic rules; some branches stressed the Buddha's supramundane nature | Influenced later Mahayana thought; **not** itself Mahayana |
| **Theravada** | **Vibhajjavada** line that wins at the **3rd Council** (Ashoka) | Doctrine of analysis; arhat ideal; strict Vinaya | **Pali** Tripitaka; Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Cambodia, Laos |
| **Sarvastivada** | Branched from the Sthaviravada line; dominant in the north | **Sarvam asti** — dharmas exist in past, present, and future | Kashmir, Gandhara, Central Asia; **Sanskrit**; **4th Council** at Kundalvana |

| School | Origin / link | Doctrine or practice | Region / canon |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Vaibhasika (Vaibhashika)** | Subschool of **Sarvastivada** | Defends orthodox Abhidharma through the ***Mahavibhasha*** | Realist reading of "all exists" |
| **Sautrantika** | Subschool of **Sarvastivada** | Accepts **sutras** as supreme authority; rejects Vaibhashika Abhidharma orthodoxy | Sutra-only emphasis — paired trap with Vaibhashika |

## 4.10 Mahayana

### How Mahayana differs from Hinayana

| Point | Hinayana / early schools | Mahayana |
|---|---|---|
| Ideal | **Arhat** — personal liberation | **Bodhisattva** — liberation for all beings |
| Buddha | Great teacher | Compassionate saviour / celestial Buddha |
| Canon | **Pali** Tripitaka | **Sanskrit** Mahayana sutras added |
| Art | Early phase often **aniconic** | Human Buddha and bodhisattva images common |
| Living line today | **Theravada** in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia | East Asia, Nepal, Tibetan world |

### Bodhisattvas — full list

| Bodhisattva | Also called | Virtue / role | Attribute or trap |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Avalokiteshvara** | **Padmapani**, Lokesvara | **Compassion**; hears the cries of all beings | Lotus; central in *Lotus Sutra*; Ajanta **Padmapani** painting |
| **Manjushri** | — | **Wisdom** | Flaming sword and **Prajnaparamita** book |
| **Vajrapani** | — | **Power** / protection | **Vajra** (thunderbolt); attendant-protector of the Buddha |
| **Maitreya** | Ajita | **Future Buddha** | Only bodhisattva widely remembered in both early and Mahayana traditions |
| **Tara** | — | **Female saviour** | Compassion goddess linked to Avalokiteshvara tradition |
| **Samantabhadra** | — | Universal virtue / practice | Often paired with Manjushri in art |
| **Kshitigarbha** | — | Earth-store bodhisattva | Saves beings in hell realms |
| **Akasagarbha** | — | "Womb of space" | Space / void symbolism |

### Mahayana philosophy schools

| School | Teacher | Key text / idea | Key fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Madhyamaka** | **Nagarjuna** | *Madhyamaka Karika*; **sunyata** (emptiness) | Middle way between eternalism and nihilism |
| **Yogacara / Vijnanavada** | **Asanga** and **Vasubandhu** | Mind-only / consciousness-only | Not Early Nikaya teaching |

## 4.11 Vajrayana

### Three vehicles — summary

| Vehicle | When | Goal | Method / canon | Living region or school |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Hinayana** | Early schools after Buddha | **Arhat** | **Pali** Tripitaka; strict Vinaya | **Theravada** in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia |

| Vehicle | When | Goal | Method / canon | Living region or school |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Mahayana** | From ~1st century CE | **Bodhisattva** | **Sanskrit** Mahayana sutras; philosophy schools | East Asia, Nepal, later eastern India |
| **Vajrayana** | From ~7th–8th century CE | **Bodhisattva** through tantra | Mantra, mandala, guru initiation | Tibet, Bhutan, parts of eastern India |

## 4.12 Cave Architecture

| Site | Type | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| **Barabar–Nagarjuni** (Bihar) | Earliest rock-cut caves | Mauryan polish; **Lomas Rishi** (लोमश ऋषि) facade; gifted to **Ajivikas** |
| **Bhaja, Karle, Bedsa, Kondane** | Western Hinayana chaityas | **Karle** (कार्ले) = largest chaitya hall |
| **Ajanta** (Maharashtra) | 30 caves; famous **paintings** | Phase I = Hinayana/aniconic; Phase II = Mahayana (Padmapani) |
| **Ellora** (एलोरा) | Multi-religion hill | Buddhist 1–12, Hindu 13–29, Jain 30–34; Cave **16** Kailasa = **Shaiva** |
| **Kanheri** (कन्हेरी) (Mumbai) | Late western Buddhist | Eleven-headed Avalokiteshvara image; Sanjay Gandhi National Park |
| **Ghantasala** | Andhra stupa | **Aryaka-pillars** on platform — named site |
| **Dhanyakataka** (Dharanikota, Andhra) | Mahasanghika centre | Later Satavahana capital tradition |

### Stupa parts (vocabulary)

| Part | What it is |
|---|---|
| **Anda** | Hemispherical dome |
| **Harmika** | Square railing on top of the dome |
| **Chhatra** | Umbrella-like finial |
| **Pradakshina path** | Circumambulation walkway; worship is **clockwise** |
| **Ayaka platform** | Cardinal platform with **ayaka / aryaka-pillars** — southern Andhra feature |

## 4.13 Ashokan Patronage

### Key Rock Edicts for Dhamma

| Edict | What it says (key fact) |
|---|---|
| **RE V** | Creates **Dhamma-mahamatras** — **13 years after coronation** (papers say "14th year"; treat as correct). These officers worked among **all religions**, cared for the poor, the aged, and prisoners. |
| **RE XII** | **Religious tolerance** — "One should honour others' faiths. Praising one's own and condemning others harms one's own religion." |
| **RE XIII** | **Kalinga remorse** — 1 lakh killed, 1.5 lakh deported. Ashoka's turn to Dhamma-vijaya. Names five Hellenistic kings (Antiochus II, Ptolemy II, Antigonus, Magas, Alexander of Epirus). |

### Rahulovada trap

- The **Bhabru / Bairat edict** lists **seven Buddhist texts** Ashoka recommended for study by monks, nuns, and laity.
- One of those seven texts is the **Laghulovada** (Rahulovada-sutta from Majjhima Nikaya) — a sermon the Buddha gave to his son Rahula about **falsehood**.

- The Rahulovada is a text Ashoka **valued**, but it is **not** the source or definition of his Dhamma. His Dhamma is his **own edict-ethic**.
- stem: "Ashoka's Dhamma is taken from the Rahulovada-sutta" → **False**.

## 4.14 Jainism

### Jiva and Ajiva (soul vs non-soul)

| Category | What it covers |
|---|---|
| **Jiva** (soul) | Every living being has a real, eternal soul. A liberated soul is called a **siddha**. This is the **opposite** of Buddhist **anatta** (no-soul). |
| **Ajiva** (non-soul) | Five types: **pudgala** (matter), **dharma** (medium of motion), **adharma** (medium of rest), **akasha** (space), **kala** (time). |

### Five types of knowledge (Jnana)

| # | Jnana | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Mati** | Sensory knowledge (ordinary perception) |
| 2 | **Shruta** | Scriptural / verbal knowledge |
| 3 | **Avadhi** | Clairvoyance (remote perception) |
| 4 | **Manahparyaya** | Telepathy (reading others' minds) |
| 5 | **Kevala** | **Omniscience** — full, unlimited knowledge. A tirthankara attains this. |

### Five Kalyanakas (auspicious events of a tirthankara)

| # | Kalyanaka | Event |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Chyavana** | Descent of the soul into the mother's womb |
| 2 | **Janma** | Birth |
| 3 | **Diksha** | Renunciation (becoming a monk) |
| 4 | **Kevala** | Attaining omniscience |
| 5 | **Nirvana** | Final liberation / death of the body |

### Three Jewels (Triratna) of Jainism

| Jewel | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Samyak Darshana** | Right faith / correct perception |
| **Samyak Jnana** | Right knowledge |
| **Samyak Charitra** | Right conduct |

### Jain philosophy — Anekantavada, Syadvada, Nayavada

| Doctrine | Meaning | Key fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Anekantavada** | Reality is **many-sided** — no single statement captures the whole truth. | "Non-absolutism" or "many-sidedness of reality." |
| **Syadvada** | Seven-fold conditional predication ("*syat*" = in some respect). A way to **speak** about many-sided reality in 7 *bhangas*. | Also called **Saptabhangi**. |
| **Nayavada** | Doctrine of **standpoints** — every judgment comes from a partial viewpoint (*naya*). | Perspective-based analysis. |

| # | Mode | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | *Syad asti* | In some respect, it **is** |
| 2 | *Syad nasti* | In some respect, it **is not** |
| 3 | *Syad asti-nasti* | In some respect, it is **and** is not |
| 4 | *Syad avaktavya* | In some respect, it is **indescribable** |
| 5–7 | Combinations | Mix existence, non-existence, and indescribability |

## 4.15 Tirthankaras

| # | Tirthankara | Key fact |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Rishabhanatha / Adinatha** | Born **Ayodhya** (UP); nirvana **Ashtapad**; symbol **bull** |
| — | **Bahubali** (son of Rishabha) | Gomateshwara at Shravanabelagola (**981 CE**); **not** one of the 24 |
| 22 | **Neminatha** | Krishna's cousin; symbol **conch**; nirvana **Girnar** |
| 23 | **Parshvanatha** | Symbol **serpent**; nirvana **Sammed Shikhar** |
| 24 | **Mahavira** | Symbol **lion**; nirvana **Pavapuri** |

## 4.16 Tirthankaras and their Symbols

| # | Tirthankara | Symbol |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rishabhanatha / Adinatha | **Bull** |
| 2 | Ajitanatha | Elephant |
| 3 | Sambhavanatha | Horse |
| 4 | Abhinandananatha | Monkey |
| 5 | Sumatinatha | Curlew / heron |
| 6 | Padmaprabha | Lotus |
| 7 | Suparshvanatha | Swastika |
| 8 | Chandraprabha | Crescent moon |
| 9 | Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha | Crocodile / makara |
| 10 | Shitalanatha | Shrivatsa |
| 11 | Shreyansanatha | Rhinoceros |
| 12 | Vasupujya | Buffalo |
| 13 | Vimalanatha | Boar |
| 14 | Anantanatha | Falcon / hawk (some lists: bear) |
| 15 | Dharmanatha | Vajra |
| 16 | Shantinatha | Deer |
| 17 | Kunthunatha | Goat |
| 18 | Aranatha | Fish / nandyavarta |
| 19 | Mallinatha | Kalasha |
| 20 | Munisuvrata | Tortoise |
| 21 | Naminatha | Blue lotus |
| 22 | Neminatha | **Conch** |

| # | Tirthankara | Symbol |
|---|---|---|
| 23 | Parshvanatha | **Serpent** |
| 24 | Mahavira | **Lion** |

## 4.17 Nirvana Sites of Tirthankaras

### Full list — all 24 nirvana sites

| # | Tirthankara | Nirvana site | State / note |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Rishabhanatha** | **Ashtapad** (Mount Kailash) | Separate site |
| 2 | Ajitanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 3 | Sambhavanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 4 | Abhinandananatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 5 | Sumatinatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 6 | Padmaprabha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 7 | Suparshvanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 8 | Chandraprabha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 9 | Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 10 | Shitalanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 11 | Shreyansanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 12 | **Vasupujya** | **Champapuri** | Bihar (Bhagalpur belt) — **2021 UPPCS trap** |
| 13 | Vimalanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 14 | Anantanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 15 | Dharmanatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 16 | Shantinatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 17 | Kunthunatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 18 | Aranatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 19 | Mallinatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 20 | Munisuvrata | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 21 | Naminatha | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand |
| 22 | **Neminatha** | **Urjayanta / Girnar** | Gujarat — separate site |
| 23 | **Parshvanatha** | Sammed Shikhar | Jharkhand (one of the 20) |
| 24 | **Mahavira** | **Pavapuri** | Bihar — separate site |

### High-yield facts

| Tirthankara | Nirvana site |
|---|---|
| **Vasupujya** (#12) | **Champapuri** (Bhagalpur, Bihar) |
| **Parshvanatha** (#23) | **Sammed Shikhar** (Jharkhand) |
| **Mahavira** (#24) | **Pavapuri** (Bihar) |
| **Neminatha** (#22) | **Girnar / Urjayanta** (Gujarat) |
| **Rishabhanatha** (#1) | **Ashtapad** (Kailash) |

## 4.18 Parshvanatha

| Fact | Parshvanatha (23rd) | Mahavira (24th) |
|---|---|---|
| Vows | **Four** (chaturyama): ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha | **Five** — added **brahmacharya** (ब्रह्मचर्य) |
| Symbol | **Serpent** | **Lion** |
| Nirvana | **Sammed Shikhar** | **Pavapuri** |
| Birth (tradition) | **Varanasi** (UP) | **Kundagrama** (Vaishali belt) |

## 4.19 Mahavira

### Timeline (traditional chronology)

| When (~BCE) | Age | Event |
|---|---|---|
| **c. 599** | 0 | Birth at **Kundagrama** (Vaishali / Vajji belt) |
| **c. 569** | **30** | **Renunciation** — left household life (Svetambara tradition) |
| **c. 569–557** | 30–42 | **12 years** of tapas (austerity) |
| **c. 557** | **42** | **Kevala jnana** (omniscience) at Jrimbhikagrama |
| **c. 557** | 42 | **First sermon** at **Vipulachala** (Rajgir) |
| **c. 557–527** | 42–72 | **30 years** of preaching |
| **c. 527** | **72** | **Nirvana** at **Pavapuri** (Magadha, Bihar) |

### Life facts

| Fact | Detail |
|---|---|
| Parents | Father **Siddhartha**; mother **Trishala** (Licchavi link) |
| Wife (Svetambara) | **Yashoda**; daughter **Priyadarshana** |
| Marriage (Digambara) | Tradition says he **never married** |
| Chief disciple | **Indrabhuti Gautama** (of 11 ganadharas) |
| Symbol | **Lion** |
| Vows | **Five** — added **brahmacharya** to Parshva's four |
| Pali name | **Nigantha Nataputta** |
| Early companion | **Makkhali Gosala** → later Ajivika teacher |
| Nirvana | **Pavapuri**, Bihar |

## 4.20 Five Great Vows

| # | Vow (Sanskrit) | Meaning | Monk (mahavrata) | Layperson (anuvrata) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Ahimsa** | Non-violence in thought, word, and deed | Strict — no harm to any being | Avoid deliberate injury |
| 2 | **Satya** | Truthfulness | No false speech | Avoid harmful lies |
| 3 | **Asteya** | Non-stealing | No taking what is not given | No theft |
| 4 | **Brahmacharya** | Chastity / celibacy | Complete celibacy | Marital fidelity |

| # | Vow (Sanskrit) | Meaning | Monk (mahavrata) | Layperson (anuvrata) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | **Aparigraha** | Non-possession | No property; sky-clad Digambaras take this furthest | Limit possessions |

## 4.21 Digambara

| Point | Digambara | Svetambara |
|---|---|---|
| Dress | **Sky-clad** (nude monks) | **White-clad** |
| Women's moksha | Must be reborn as **men** (classic view) | **Women can** attain moksha |
| Canon | **Shatkhandagama**, **Kasayapahuda** | **12 Angas** (11 survive; **Drishtivada** lost) |
| Mallinatha | **Male** | **Female** |
| Geography | South — **Shravanabelagola**, Karnataka | North — **Vallabhi** final redaction |

## 4.22 Svetambara

### Jain councils and canon

| # | Place | Leader | When (approx.) | Outcome |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1st** | **Pataliputra** (Bihar) | **Sthulabhadra** | ~300 BCE | **12 Angas** arranged in **Ardhamagadhi**. **Drishtivada** (12th Anga) later **lost**. |
| **2nd** (two venues at once) | **Mathura** (UP) and **Vallabhi** (Gujarat) | **Skandila** (Mathura); **Nagarjuna** (Vallabhi I) | ~4th c. CE | Oral texts gathered again after famine; Mathura is the **UP** venue. |
| **3rd** (final) | **Vallabhi** (Maitraka Gujarat) | **Devardhigani Kshamashramana** | ~453–512 CE | Svetambara **Agamas written down**; **11 Angas** + **Upangas**. |

## 4.23 Shramana Tradition

### Six rival teachers (*Samañ̃aphala Sutta*)

| Teacher | Doctrine | One-line fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Purana Kassapa** | **Akriya** | Deeds have **no moral fruit** |
| **Makkhali Gosala** | **Niyati** (Ajivika) | **Fate** fixes all; effort cannot rewrite destiny |
| **Ajita Kesakambalin** | **Uccheda** materialism | Body is elements; **death is the end** |
| **Pakudha Kaccayana** | Seven eternal elements | No real moral agency |
| **Nigantha Nataputta** | Jain path | This is **Mahavira** — ahimsa and soul |
| **Sanjaya Belatthiputta** | Scepticism | The "eel-wriggler" — refused definite answers on soul and rebirth |

## 4.24 Ajivika Sect

| Fact | Detail |
|---|---|
| Founder-teacher | **Makkhali Gosala** — wandered with Mahavira, then broke away |
| Core doctrine | **Niyati** (fate) runs the universe; **effort cannot rewrite destiny** |

| Fact | Detail |
|---|---|
| Practice | Still practised **hard asceticism** despite fatalism |
| Patronage | **Bindusara** (बिन्दुसार) favoured Ajivikas; **Ashoka** gifted **Barabar** caves to them |
| Fate | Sect **dies out after the Mauryas**; known mainly from Buddhist and Jain polemics |
| Sites | **Barabar** caves (Ajivika) vs **Ajanta** (Buddhist paintings) |

## 4.25 Charvaka (Lokayata)

| Fact | Charvaka position |
|---|---|
| **Pramana** | **Pratyaksha** (perception) is the **sole** valid means of knowledge |
| God / soul | **No** creator God, **no** soul, **no** afterlife |
| Karma / yajna | **No** karma, **no** rebirth, **no** Vedic yajna fruit |
| Ethics | **This-world** pleasure; "go loot" is **polemic**, not the doctrine |
| Founder-name | **Brihaspati** (traditional) |
| Sources | Original canon **lost**; recovered from opponents like Madhava's *Sarvadarshanasangraha* |
| Related name | **Charaka Samhita** (चरक संहिता) = Ayurveda; **Brihaspati** = Lokayata founder-name |

## 4.27 Heterodox Schools

| School | Reject Veda? | Soul / karma? | One-line |
|---|---|---|---|
| Buddhism | Yes | No permanent soul; karma yes | Middle Path |
| Jainism | Yes | Soul yes; karma as matter | Ahimsa, 24 jinas |
| Ajivika | Yes | Fate over karma-ethic | Niyati |
| Charvaka | Yes | Neither | Perception-only |

## 4.28 Hinduism

### Six orthodox (astika) schools

| School | Focus |
|---|---|
| **Nyaya** (न्याय) | Logic and epistemology |
| **Vaisheshika** (वैशेषिक) | Atomism and categories |
| **Samkhya** (सांख्य) | Dualism: purusha and prakriti |
| **Yoga** (योग) | Discipline of mind and body (Patanjali) |
| **Mimamsa** (मीमांसा) | Vedic ritual interpretation |
| **Vedanta** (वेदांत) | Upanishadic philosophy (Advaita, Vishishtadvaita, Dvaita) |

## 4.29 Shaivism

| Jyotirlinga | Place |
|---|---|
| Somnath | Gujarat |
| Mallikarjuna / Srisailam | Andhra Pradesh |

| Jyotirlinga | Place |
|---|---|
| Mahakaleshwar | Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh |
| Omkareshwar | Madhya Pradesh |
| Kedarnath | Uttarakhand |
| Bhimashankar | Maharashtra |
| **Kashi Vishwanath** | **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश) |
| Trimbakeshwar | Maharashtra |
| Vaidyanath / Baidyanath | Jharkhand (Deoghar claim) |
| Nageshwar | Gujarat |
| Rameshwaram | Tamil Nadu |
| Grishneshwar | Maharashtra |

## 4.30 Vaishnavism

| Avatar | Note |
|---|---|
| Matsya | Fish |
| Kurma | Tortoise |
| Varaha | Boar |
| Narasimha | Man-lion |
| Vamana | Dwarf |
| Parashurama | Axe-Rama |
| Rama | Ayodhya |
| Krishna | Mathura |
| Buddha or Balarama | Lists vary |
| Kalki | Future |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| First sermon | **Sarnath**, Varanasi (Deer Park) |
| Mahaparinirvana | **Kushinagar** |
| Jetavana / Kosala | **Shravasti** |
| Descent from heaven (tradition) | **Sankisa** (Farrukhabad) |
| Kosambi monastery | **Kaushambi** |
| Parshvanatha birth tradition | **Varanasi** |
| Rishabhanatha birth tradition | **Ayodhya** |
| Jain images / stupa | Mathura **Kankali Tila** |
| Bhagavata / Krishna | **Mathura–Vrindavan** |
| Rama | **Ayodhya** |
| Jyotirlinga | **Kashi Vishwanath** |
| Shakta | Vindhyachal (Mirzapur) |

## 4.34 Shaiva, Bhagavata & Shakta High-Yield Spines

- **Cosmogonic Cycles:** 4 Epochs in order: **Krita** → **Treta** → **Dvapara** → **Kaliyuga**.
- **Bhagavatism Origins:** Krishna (son of Devaki, disciple of **Ghor Angirasa**) mentioned in *Chhandogya Upanishad*. Panini records worshippers of Vasudeva as **Vasudevaka**. Megasthenes notes people of Shurasena (Mathura) worshipped **Heracles** (= Vasudeva-Krishna).
- **Epigraphic Proof: Heliodorus Garuda Pillar** at Besnagar (Vidisha, MP) — Greek ambassador calls himself *Bhagavata* and Vasudeva *Devadevas* (God of Gods).
- **Bhakti Saints of South India:**
- **Alvars (12):** Devoted to Vishnu; only female saint was **Andal** (god-intoxicated poetess).
- **Nayanars (63):** Devoted to Shiva; leading figures: **Tirujnanasambandar (Sambandar)**, **Appar**, **Sundaramurti (Sundarar)**, **Manikkavachakar**.
- **Chola temple conflict:** Staunch Shaiva Chola king **Kulottunga II** threw the idol of Govindaraja (Vishnu) from Chidambaram temple into the sea.
- **Shaiva Sects (*Vamana Purana* 4 schools):** 1. *Shaiva* (ordinary devotees) 2. *Pashupata* — founded by **Lakulisha** (2nd century BCE; considered Shiva's incarnation) 3. *Kapalika* — worship Shiva as ferocious **Bhairava**; ascetic rituals with human skull (*naramunda*) 4. *Kalamukha* — extreme ascetic practices
- *Lingayat / Virashaiva* founded by **Basava** in Karnataka.
- *Nathpanth* founded by **Matsyendranatha** and organized by **Gorakhnatha**.
- **12 Jyotirlingas:** Somnath (Gujarat), Nageshwar (Gujarat), Kedarnath (UK), Kashi Vishwanath (UP), Baidyanath (Jharkhand), Mahakaleshwar (Ujjain MP), Omkareshwar (MP), Bhimashankar (Maharashtra), Trimbakeshwar (Nashik MH), Ghushmeshwar (Rajasthan), Mallikarjuna (Srisailam AP), Rameshwaram (TN).
- **Major Shakta Temples:** Kamakhya (Guwahati, Assam), Vindhyavasini Devi (Vindhyachal, Mirzapur UP), Chausath Yogini (Morena, MP), Parvati Temple (Nachna-Kuthara, MP), Dakshineswar Kali (WB).

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **First council at Vaishali** → **Rajagriha**; Vaishali = 2nd (2025).
2. **Kundalvana before Pataliputra** → Kundalvana is **4th**.
3. **Nagarjuna wrote Milinda Panha** → **Nagasena** (2023).
4. **Rahulovada = Ashoka's Dhamma definition** → **false** (2024).
5. **Barabar = Buddhist Ajanta** → Barabar = **Ajivika**, Mauryan.
6. **Aryaka pillars at Bodh Gaya** → **Ghantasala** (2022).
7. **Vasupujya = Sammed Shikhar** → **Champapuri** (2021).
8. **Mahavira symbol = serpent** → **lion**; serpent = **Parshva**.
9. **All 24 nirvana at Sammed Shikhar** → only **20**; four exceptions.
10. **Chaitya = vihara** → hall vs monastery.
11. **Buddhism accepts atman** → **anatta**.
12. **Charvaka = Ajivika** → perception-only vs **niyati**.
13. **Charaka Samhita = Lokayata** → Ayurveda.
14. **Ellora 16 = Buddhist** → **Shaiva** Kailasa.
15. **Lumbini in UP** → **Nepal**; UP = Sarnath + Kushinagar (+ Shravasti, Sankisa, Kaushambi).
16. **Mahavira founded Jainism / was 1st tirthankara** → 24th; first = **Rishabha**.
17. **Vallabhi = 2nd Buddhist council** → Jain **Svetambara** canon; Buddhist 2nd = **Vaishali**.
18. **Digambara: Mahavira married Yashoda** → that is **Svetambara**; Digambara: never married.

19. **Anekantavada = Buddhist Middle Path** → Jain many-sided real; Middle Path = Buddha.
20. **Tattvartha Sutra = Digambara-only** → **both** sects (Umasvati).
21. **Hinayana = Theravada only** → Theravada is the **only surviving** Hinayana school; Sarvastivada and Mahasanghika were separate early lines.
22. **Mahasanghika = Mahayana** → Vaishali **early split** vs later **great vehicle**.
23. **Vaibhashika / Sautrantika = separate vehicles** → both are **Sarvastivada subschools**.
24. **Vajrayana at Buddha's time** → **7th–8th century CE** tantric offshoot of Mahayana.
25. **All bodhisattvas in one comma line** → learn **Avalokiteshvara, Manjushri, Vajrapani, Maitreya, Tara** as separate facts.

# Topic 5 — Sixth Century BCE

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Janapada | Mahajanapada | Clan territory vs the **16** large states | जनपद / महाजनपद |
| Monarchy | Gana-sangha | Hereditary king vs oligarchic clan-council | राजतंत्र / गणसंघ |
| Rajagriha | Pataliputra | Early Magadha capital vs later Ganga–Son capital | राजगृह / पाटलिपुत्र |
| Ajatashatru (Patali) | Udayin (capital) | Fortifies / founds **Pataligrama** seed vs first makes **Pataliputra** the capital | अजातशत्रु / उदयन |
| Udayin (Magadha) | Udayana (Vatsa) | Haryanka capital-shifter vs Vatsa king of Kaushambi | उदयन मगध / उदयन वत्स |
| Matsya | Surasena | **Viratnagar** (Rajasthan) vs **Mathura** | मत्स्य / शूरसेन |
| Kashi | Kosala | Varanasi vs Ayodhya / **Shravasti** | काशी / कोसल |
| Vatsa | Panchala | **Kaushambi** vs Ahichchhatra / Kampilya | वत्स / पांचाल |
| Magadha | Vajji | Magadhan **kingdom** (Bihar) vs Licchavi **republic** (Vaishali) | मगध / वज्जि |
| Bimbisara | Ajatashatru | Alliances + **Anga** vs parricide + **Vajji** war | बिम्बिसार / अजातशत्रु |
| Haryanka | Shishunaga | Bimbisara line vs minister who **took Avanti** | हर्यंक / शिशुनाग |
| Mahapadma | Dhana Nanda | Founder / ekarat vs last Nanda, **Alexander age** | महापद्म / धननन्द |
| Potana | Pratishthana | Asmaka capital in 2020 paper vs later Satavahana Paithan | पोतन / प्रतिष्ठान |
| PGW | NBPW | Later Vedic doab grey ware vs **mahajanapada / early historic** deluxe black ware | चित्रित धूसर / उत्तरी काली |
| Girivraja | Pataliputra | Rajgir five-hill fort vs Ganga–Son city | गिरिव्रज / पाटलिपुत्र |
| Kushinagar | Pava | Both **Malla** vs Jain **Pavapuri** (Mahavira) in Magadha | कुशीनगर / पावा |
| Champa | Varanasi | **Anga** river-port vs **Kashi** | चम्पा / वाराणसी |
| Buddha-age ganas | Yaudheya | Shakya / Licchavi / Malla list vs later plains **gana** (not "earlier republic" stem) | गण / यौधेय |
| Avantika | Taxila | Ancient name / pole of **Ujjain** vs **Gandhara** university town | अवन्तिका / तक्षशिला |

## 5.2 Sixteen Mahajanapadas

| # | Mahajanapada | Capital | River / belt |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Kashi** | Varanasi | Ganga |
| 2 | **Kosala** | Shravasti / Ayodhya | Sarayu |
| 3 | **Anga** | Champa | Ganga (port) |
| 4 | **Magadha** (मगध) | Rajagriha → Pataliputra | Ganga + Son |
| 5 | **Vajji** (Vrijji) | Vaishali | Gandak belt |
| 6 | **Malla** | Kushinagar / Pava | Rapti–Gandak edge |
| 7 | **Chedi** | Shuktimati | Ken / Bundelkhand |
| 8 | **Vatsa** | Kaushambi | Yamuna |
| 9 | **Kuru** | Indraprastha / Hastinapur | Yamuna–Ganga doab |
| 10 | **Panchala** | Ahichchhatra / Kampilya | Ganga (Rohilkhand) |

| # | Mahajanapada | Capital | River / belt |
|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | **Matsya** | Viratnagar (Bairat) | Rajasthan |
| 12 | **Surasena** | Mathura | Yamuna |
| 13 | **Asmaka** (Assaka) | **Potana** / Potali | **Godavari** (गोदावरी) |
| 14 | **Avanti** | Ujjain / Mahishmati | Shipra / **Narmada** (नर्मदा) |
| 15 | **Gandhara** (गांधार) | Taxila (also Pushkalavati) | Indus |
| 16 | **Kamboja** | Rajapura | Hindu Kush |

## 5.2a Gana-Sangha Polity — Vajji and Malla

| Feature | Gana-sangha (e.g. Vajji, Malla) | Monarchy (e.g. Magadha, Kosala) |
|---|---|---|
| Ruler | Clan assembly / oligarchy | Hereditary king |
| Capital examples | Vaishali, Kushinagar | Rajagriha, Shravasti |
| Army | Clan levies | Standing **chaturanga** force |
| trap | Vajji is **not** one of the "four monarchies" | Magadha is **not** a gana |

## 5.3 Mahajanapadas of Uttar Pradesh

| State | UP fact |
|---|---|
| Kashi | Varanasi — oldest continuous city on this list |
| Kosala | **Ayodhya** (अयोध्या) + **Shravasti** (Saheth-Maheth, crescent plan); Prasenajit |
| Vatsa | **Kaushambi** (Prayagraj) — Udayana; NBPW + rampart |
| Kuru | **Hastinapur** (हस्तिनापुर) (Meerut); Indraprastha = Delhi NCR |
| Panchala | **Ahichchhatra** (Bareilly), Kampilya (Farrukhabad); Kanyakubja belt |
| Malla | **Kushinagar** + Pava |
| Surasena | **Mathura** |
| Chedi | Banda–Chitrakoot / Bundelkhand — capital Shuktimati / Sotthivati |

## 5.6 Rise of Magadha

| Dynasty | Approx. span (Buddhist coaching line) |
|---|---|
| Haryanka | ~544–412 BCE |
| Shishunaga | ~412–344 BCE |
| Nanda | ~344–321 BCE |
| Maurya | ~321–184 BCE |
| Shunga | ~184–75 BCE |

## 5.10 Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)

| Ware | Date (approx.) | Key fact |
|---|---|---|
| **OCP** | Late 3rd–2nd millennium BCE | Doab rural, before PGW |
| **PGW** | ~1100–600 BCE | Later Vedic doab |

| Ware | Date (approx.) | Key fact |
|---|---|---|
| **NBPW** | ~700–200 BCE | Mahajanapada + early historic cities |

## UP Focus

| Mahajanapada | Capital / district fact |
|---|---|
| Kashi | Varanasi |
| Kosala | Ayodhya + Shravasti (crescent plan) |
| Vatsa | Kaushambi (Prayagraj) |
| Kuru | Hastinapur (Meerut); Indraprastha = Delhi |
| Panchala | Ahichchhatra (Bareilly), Kampilya; Kanyakubja belt |
| Malla | Kushinagar |
| Surasena | Mathura |
| Chedi | Bundelkhand (Banda–Chitrakoot edge) |
| UP town (extra) | **Kalpi** — Yamuna, Jalaun; ancient Kalpriya |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Matsya = Mathura** → Mathura = **Surasena**; Matsya = **Viratnagar** (2020).
2. **Asmaka = Pratishthana/Paithan** in that 2020 list → **Potana**.
3. **Magadha / Vajji / Anga in UP** → **Bihar**.
4. **Pataliputra founded by Chandragupta / Ashoka** → **Ajatashatru** seeds / founds; **Udayin** first makes it the **capital**.
5. **Shishunaga founded Pataliputra** → he **took Avanti** (and some keys give him Varanasi as second capital).
6. **Shakya = one of the 16** → under Kosala; not the canonical sixteen.
7. **Alexander defeated the Nandas** → turned at the **Beas**.
8. **Vajji = Magadhan monarchy** → **gana-sangha**.
9. **First Magadha conquest = Vajji** → **Anga** (Bimbisara); Vajji = Ajatashatru.
10. **Kalashoka = First Council** → **Second**, Vaishali.
11. **Kashi = Kosala** → two mahajanapadas; Varanasi vs Shravasti/Ayodhya.
12. **Ahichchhatra = Vatsa / Kosala** → **Panchala**; Vatsa = Kaushambi; Kosala = Saket/Shravasti.
13. **6th c. BCE = Mauryan empire** → mahajanapadas; Mauryas start ~322 BCE.
14. **Avanti in UP** → **Malwa / MP**.
15. **Malla capital = Vaishali** → Vaishali = **Vajji**; Malla = **Kushinagar**.
16. **Pava (Malla) = Pavapuri (Mahavira)** → two different places.
17. **NBPW = PGW / "only Mauryan"** → NBPW starts in mahajanapada towns.
18. **Bimbisara annexed Avanti** → **Shishunaga**.
19. **Mahapadma = Chandragupta** → Nanda founder vs Mauryan founder.
20. **Kamboja = Asmaka** → horses/NW vs Godavari/south.
21. **Shakya = 16th mahajanapada** → under Kosala.
22. **Jarasandha = Haryanka king** → epic/Puranic Brihadratha memory, not the Bimbisara list.
23. **Udayin (Magadha) = Udayana (Vatsa)** → capital-shifter vs Kaushambi king.
24. **Yaudheya = Buddha-age "earlier republic"** → later gana; not in that early list.
25. **Surasena = Kaushambi** → Mathura; Kaushambi = Vatsa.

26. **First extant coins = gold** → punch-marked **silver** (Aahat).
27. **Kosala capital = Ahichchhatra** → Ahichchhatra = Panchala.

# Topic 6 — Foreign Invasions

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hydaspes | Hyphasis | **Jhelum** — battle vs Porus vs **Beas** — mutiny / turn-back | झेलम / ब्यास |
| Ambhi | Porus | Taxila **ally** vs Paurava **enemy-then-satrap** | अंभि / पोरस |
| Alexander | Seleucus | 326 campaign vs **~305** war/treaty with Chandragupta | सिकंदर / सेल्यूकस |
| Seleucus | Indo-Greeks | Syrian-Bactrian successor of Alexander vs **Bactrian Greeks inside India** later | सेल्यूकस / इंडो-ग्रीक |
| Menander | Nagasena | King **Milinda** vs monk of *Milinda Panha* | मेनांडर / नागसेन |
| Menander | Nagarjuna | Indo-Greek king vs Madhyamaka philosopher | मेनांडर / नागार्जुन |
| Aristotle | Aristobulus | Tutor, **never in India** vs engineer-historian **on the march** | अरस्तू / अरिस्टोबुलस |
| Megasthenes | Nearchus | Seleucid **envoy after 303** vs Alexander's **admiral** | मेगस्थनीज / नियार्कस |
| Greeks | Sakas | Hellenistic (2nd c. BCE) vs Scythians **after** them (2023) | यूनानी / शक |
| Indo-Greek | Kushan | Menander / Sagala vs **Kanishka**, Purushapura, era **78 CE** | इंडो-ग्रीक / कुषाण |
| Bucephala | Nicaea | City for the horse vs victory-city after Hydaspes | बुसेफला / नीकेया |
| Kalanos | Dandamis | Gymnosophist who *went* with Alexander vs the one who **refused** | कलानोस / दंडामिस |
| Sagala | Sangala | Menander's **Sialkot** vs Kathaioi town Alexander **stormed** | सागल / संगला |
| Vikrama 57 BCE | Shaka 78 CE | Traditional Vikramaditya vs **Kanishka-era** count | विक्रम / शक |
| Agathocles | Menander | Early Brahmi/Vaishnava coin types vs Milinda / Athena types | अगाथोक्लीज / मेनांडर |
| Maues | Gondophares | **Shaka** Indo-Scythian first at Taxila vs **Parthian** Pahlava at Takht-i-Bahi | माउस / गोंडोफेरिस |
| Nahapana | Rudradaman | Kshaharata, beaten by Gautamiputra vs Kardamaka, Junagadh Sanskrit | नहपान / रुद्रदामन |
| Kujula Kadphises | Vima Kadphises | Kushan **founder/unifier** vs **gold** coin headline | कुजुल / विम |
| Purushapura | Sagala | Kushan **Peshawar** capital vs Indo-Greek **Sialkot** | पुरुषपुर / सागल |
| Hathigumpha | Junagadh | Kharavela's Kalinga cave vs Rudradaman's Shaka rock | हाथीगुफा / जूनागढ़ |
| Gondophares | Kanishka | Brief **Parthian** NW vs **Kushan** empire peak | गोंडोफेरिस / कनिष्क |
| Demetrius I | Menander | First big Indo-Greek **push** vs greatest Indo-Greek / **Milinda** | डेमेट्रियस / मेनांडर |
| Kujula | Kanishka | Founder / unifier vs imperial **climax** + era **78 CE** | कुजुल / कनिष्क |
| Gandhara art | Mathura art | NW **schist**, Greco-Roman vs UP **red sandstone**, indigenous | गांधार / मथुरा |
| Kushan dress | Mauryan dhoti look | Coat + **trousers** + boots vs Indian lower-garment royal memory | कुषाण वेश / धोती |
| Early Mathura Shiva | Chola Nataraja | Linga / mukhalinga / Oesho under Kushan vs later Tamil **bronze dancer** | मथुरा शिव / चोल नटराज |
| Booted Surya | Barefoot South Surya | North Indian **udichya-vesa** (Shaka–Kushan) vs southern bare legs | सूर्य जूते / दक्षिणी सूर्य |

## Books and Writers — Foreign Invasions Age

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Anabasis* (and related *Indica*) | **Arrian** | Alexander's Indian march (draws on Ptolemy and Aristobulus) |
| *Indica* (Mauryan India) | **Megasthenes** | Seleucid envoy after ~303 BCE; Chandragupta's court |

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| India–Persia notes | **Ctesias** | Physician to Artaxerxes II |
| Gymnosophist / march notes | **Onesicritus** | Helmsman-writer with Alexander |
| *Milinda Panha* | **Menander (Milinda)** and **Nagasena** | Indo-Greek Buddhist dialogue |

## 6.1 Greek Invasion

| Year | Macedonian step |
|---|---|
| 334 | Granicus |
| 333 | Issus |
| **331** | **Gaugamela** |
| 330 | Persepolis |
| 329–327 | Bactria–Sogdiana |
| **326** | **India** |

## 6.7 Shakas

### Kings — north-west line

- **Maues**, also called **Moga**, is the earliest Indo-Scythian king named in India. He establishes Shaka power in **Gandhara** and around **Taxila**.
- His rule runs on both sides of the Indus, from **Pushkalavati** in the west to **Taxila** in the east. His capital tradition points to **Sirkap**.
- His coins are mostly copper with some silver. Obverse types mix Greek deities with **Shiva** and **Buddha**.
- **Azes I** is the usual successor in numismatic lists. He finishes off remaining Indo-Greek pockets in the Punjab belt.

## 6.11 Dress, Sculpture, and Iconography under the Foreign Waves

### Two art schools

| School | Zone | Stone | Look |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Gandhara** | NW (Peshawar–Taxila–Afghan belt) | Grey / green **schist** (also stucco) | Greco-Roman Buddha face, wavy hair, heavy drapery |
| **Mathura** | **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश) | Mottled **red sandstone** | Indigenous body types, yaksha heritage, smiling / robust figures |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Hydaspes = Beas** → Jhelum = fight; Beas = **stop**.
2. **Alexander beat the Nandas / sat at Pataliputra** → never crossed the Beas.
3. **Ambhi fought at Hydaspes as the enemy** → **ally**; enemy = **Porus**.
4. **Porus was killed** → restored as satrap.
5. **Aristotle / Megasthenes / Chanakya / Deimachus in the Macedonian column** → no (Deimachus = Bindusara envoy).
6. **Megasthenes = Alexander's admiral** → admiral = **Nearchus**; Megasthenes = **Seleucus's envoy**.
7. **Seleucus conquered Magadha** → he **ceded** NW tracts, took **500 elephants**.

8. **Kushans before Sakas** (2023 B) → **Greeks** → **Sakas** → **Kushans**.
9. **Nagarjuna wrote Milinda Panha** → **Nagasena**.
10. **Menander = Alexander's general** → 2nd c. BCE Indo-Greek.
11. **Besnagar pillar = Pushyamitra's ashwamedha site** → Besnagar is **Heliodorus**; Pushyamitra's ashwamedha tradition is tied to **Ayodhya** in that stem.
12. **Kanishka = Indo-Greek** → **Kushan** (Purushapura, era 78 CE).
13. **Alexander died at Taxila in 326** → **Babylon, 323**.
14. **First foreigners in the NW = Alexander** → **Achaemenids** (Darius).
15. **Indo-Greek coins = punch-marked karshapana** → die-struck portraits, Greek + Kharoshthi.
16. **Sangala = Sagala** → Kathaioi town Alexander stormed ≠ Menander's Sialkot.
17. **Kalanos = Dandamis** → one went, one refused.
18. **Indo-Greeks introduced Gupta gold dinaras** → portrait silver; **gold = Kushan** headline.
19. **Shaka era = 57 BCE** → **78 CE**; 57 BCE = **Vikrama**.
20. **Yavana raid on Pataliputra = Alexander 326** → later Indo-Greek / *Yuga Purana* memory.
21. **Maues = Kushan** → **Shaka** first at Taxila.
22. **Rudradaman = Indo-Greek** → **Shaka** mahakshatrapa; Junagadh Sanskrit.
23. **Nahapana = Kardamaka** → **Kshaharata**; beaten by Gautamiputra.
24. **Gondophares = Shaka** → **Parthian**; Takht-i-Bahi fact.
25. **Fourth Buddhist Council = Ashoka** → **Kanishka**, Kashmir / Vasumitra.
26. **Hathigumpha = Kanishka** (2018 option) → **Kharavela**.
27. **Purushapura = Sagala** → Peshawar Kushan vs Sialkot Indo-Greek.
28. **Massaga women = Kathaioi / Sangala** → Assakenoi capital **Massaga**.
29. **Alexander success = good administrator** → not a standard cause; use no central power + army + traitors.
30. **Kushan kings wore dhoti like Ashoka's pillar figures** → Mat / coin portraits show **coat, trousers, boots**.
31. **Chola Nataraja = Kanishka's Mathura sculpture** → Nataraja is later Tamil bronze; Kushan Mathura = early Shiva linga / Buddha / royal portraits.
32. **Gandhara = red sandstone of Mathura** → Gandhara = **schist** / Greco-Roman NW; Mathura = **red sandstone** UP.
33. **Demetrius = Menander** → Demetrius = early push; Menander = greatest / Milinda.
34. **Vima = founder of Kushans** → founder = **Kujula**; Vima = **gold** headline.

# Topic 7 — Mauryan Empire

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Chandragupta Maurya | Chandragupta II | 322 BCE founder vs Gupta **Vikramaditya** | चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य / द्वितीय |
| Samaharta | Sannidhata | **Collects** revenue vs **stores** the kosha | समाहर्ता / संनिधाता |
| RE XII | RE XIII | **Samavaya** / religious concord (2022) vs **Kalinga** | बारहवाँ / तेरहवाँ |
| RE XIII | Separate Kalinga edicts | Full Kalinga text on most sites vs **Dhauli/Jaugada** ("all men are my children") | तेरहवाँ / कलिंग पृथक |
| Major RE | Minor RE | 14-set, title Piyadassi vs local; **Maski names Ashoka** | प्रमुख / लघु |
| Dhamma | Buddhism | Ethical **state policy** vs the religion he patronised | धम्म / बौद्ध |
| Kautilya | Megasthenes | Sanskrit *Arthashastra* vs Greek *Indica* | कौटिल्य / मेगस्थनीज |
| Agronomai | Pautavadhyaksha | Rural **revenue/land** (2020 D) vs **weights** | एग्रोनोमोई / पौतवाध्यक्ष |
| Barabar | Ajanta | Mauryan polish, **Ajivika** gift vs later Buddhist painted caves | बराबर / अजंता |
| Rajuka | Dhamma-mahamatra | Land/justice (PE) vs **moral/welfare** cadre (RE V) | राजुक / धम्म-महामात्र |
| Bherighosha | Dhammaghosha | War-drum vs **dhamma-drum** (RE IV / XIII) | भेरीघोष / धम्मघोष |
| RE V | PE V | **Dhamma-mahamatras** vs **protected-animal** list | शैल ५ / स्तंभ ५ |
| Six city boards | Six army boards | Crafts/foreigners/census… vs navy/transport/infantry… | नगर षट् / सेना षट् |
| Bhaga | Bali | Produce **share** vs extra/religious levy (Rummindei drops *bali*) | भाग / बलि |
| Sudama | Lomas Rishi | Polished Ajivika cell vs **horseshoe chaitya-arch** facade | सुदामा / लोमश ऋषि |
| Ahraura | Sarnath | UP **Minor Rock** (Mirzapur) vs UP **lion capital** | अह्रौरा / सारनाथ |
| Kunala | Tivala | Blinded-son legend vs **Queen's edict** son of Karuvaki | कुणाल / तिवल |
| Sanstha | Sanchara | Stationary covers vs **mobile** spies | संस्था / संचार |
| Moriya kshatriya | Purana shudra | Buddhist Pipphalivana origin vs Brahmanical **low-birth** smear | मोरिय / पुराण |

## Books and Writers — Mauryan Age

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Arthashastra* (अर्थशास्त्र) | **Kautilya / Chanakya / Vishnugupta** (कौटिल्य / चाणक्य / विष्णुगुप्त) | Sanskrit statecraft; saptanga, officials, courts |
| *Indica* | **Megasthenes** | Greek envoy account of Chandragupta's India (lost; known via Strabo, Arrian) |
| *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) | **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) | Sanskrit play on Chandragupta–Chanakya court intrigue |
| Commentary on *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) | **Dhundiraja** (धुन्दिराज) | Later commentary on Vishakhadatta's play |
| *Devichandraguptam* (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्) | **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) | Drama remembered with Gupta-age story (same author; later setting) |

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Abhisarikavanchitaka* (अभिसारिकावंचितक) | **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) | Another work attributed to the same dramatist |
| *Dipavamsa* | Sinhalese Buddhist chronicle | Third Council at Pataliputra under Ashoka |
| *Mahavamsa* | Sinhalese Buddhist chronicle | Same council; Moggaliputta Tissa; Lanka missions |
| *Divyavadana* | Buddhist anthology | Taxila revolt under Bindusara; Ashoka as *kumara* |
| *Samantapasadika* | **Buddhaghosa** | Ashoka / Avanti tradition in Bindusara's reign |
| *Ashokavadana* | Buddhist tradition | Ashokan succession legends (use lightly) |
| *Vishnu Purana* | Puranic tradition | Maurya genealogy (**UPPCS 2023**) |
| *Manusmriti* | Manu tradition | Contrast text: widow remarriage barred; "fallen kshatriyas" |
| *The Prince* (*Il Principe*) | **Machiavelli** | European compare-text for *Arthashastra* (not a Mauryan book) |
| *Laghulovada / Rahulovada* | Buddhist sutta (not written by Ashoka) | Listed for monks in the **Bhabru** edict |

## 7.1 Mauryan Empire

### King line (overview)

| Ruler | Span (approx.) | Must-hold fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Chandragupta** (चंद्रगुप्त) | 322–297 BCE | Overthrows **Dhana Nanda**; Greek **Sandrokottos** |
| **Bindusara** | 297–273 BCE | Greek **Amitraghata / Amitrochates** |
| **Ashoka** | Accedes ~272; crowned 268–232 BCE | **Kalinga** (कलिंग), **dhamma** (धम्म), and the edicts |
| **Brihadratha** | ends 185 BCE | Killed by **Pushyamitra Shunga (Pushyamitra Sunga)** |

### Neighbours, pottery, coins, and army size

| Named in RE II | Fact |
|---|---|
| **Chola** (चोल) | South neighbour |
| **Pandya** | South neighbour |
| **Satiyaputra** | South neighbour |
| **Keralaputra** | South neighbour |
| **Tamraparni** | Sri Lanka; neighbour / mission land, not a province |
| **Yonas** | Greek / Yavana neighbours |
| **Kambojas** | Northwest neighbours |

## 7.5 Important Mauryan Officials

### Revenue pair (first swap-trap)

- The **samaharta collects** all revenue.
- The **sannidhata stores** the *kosha* (treasury).
- Never reverse collector and storekeeper.

## 7.7 Ashoka's Dhamma

### The Bhabru / Rahulovada trap

- The **Bhabru** edict (also called **Calcutta-Bairat**) is a message to the **sangha**.
- In it Ashoka lists Buddhist texts for monks. One of them is ***Laghulovada*** (also called ***Rahulovada***).
- So Ashoka **knew** the sutta and valued it for monks.
- Knowing a sutta is **not** the same as defining state Dhamma from that sutta.
- UPPCS **2024** still treats this claim as **false**: "Ashoka's Dhamma definition is taken from *Rahulovada-sutta*."

## 7.8 Major Rock Edicts

| RE | Fact |
|---|---|
| **I** | Ban/limit on slaughter and *samajas*; royal kitchen cut |
| **II** | Hospitals, herbs, wells; **Chola–Pandya–Satiyaputra–Keralaputra–Tamraparni** named |
| **III** | *Yukta, rajuka, pradeshika* tour **every 5 years** |
| **IV** | **Dhammaghosha** replaces bherighosha |
| **V** | **Dhamma-mahamatras** created |
| **VI** | King reachable at all times; *pativedakas* |
| **VII** | All sects may dwell everywhere |
| **VIII** | Dhamma-tours; Bodh Gaya (*sambodhi*) |
| **IX** | Useless rites vs true dhamma |
| **X** | Fame only through dhamma |
| **XI** | *Dhamma-dana* (gift of dhamma) |
| **XII** | **Samavaya / religious synthesis** ← |
| **XIII** | **Kalinga**; five Greek kings (**Antioka** = Antiochus II Theos of Syria; **Turamaya** = Ptolemy II Philadelphus of Egypt; **Antikini** = Antigonus Gonatas of Macedonia; **Maka** = Magas of Cyrene; **Alikasudara** = Alexander of Epirus); dhamma-vijaya |
| **XIV** | Edicts written short or long as the place needs |
| Site | Region |
| ------ | -------- |
| **Girnar (Junagadh)** | Gujarat |
| **Kalsi** | Dehradun, Uttarakhand |
| **Dhauli** | Odisha |
| **Jaugada** | Odisha |
| **Shahbazgarhi** | KP, Pakistan |
| **Mansehra** | KP, Pakistan |
| **Sopara** (शूर्पारक) | Maharashtra |
| **Erragudi / Yerragudi** | Andhra |
| **Sannati (Kanaganahalli)** | Karnataka |

## 7.10 Pillar Edicts

| PE | Fact |
|---|---|
| **I** | Self-check; little sin |
| **II** | **Defines dhamma** (compassion, liberality, truth, purity) |
| **III** | Deeds vs mere rites |
| **IV** | **Rajukas** independent justice; capital cases |
| **V** | Closed slaughter-days; **list of protected animals** (not dhamma-mahamatras — those are **RE V**) |
| **VI** | Inscriptions from the **12th** year onward |
| **VII** | Longest; "gift of dhamma is the best gift"; only on **Delhi-Topra** in full |
| Shaft | Place |
| --- | --- |
| **Sarnath** | Varanasi, UP |
| **Sanchi** | MP |
| **Vaishali (Bakhira)** | Bihar |
| **Sankissa** | Farrukhabad belt |
| **Lauriya-Nandangarh / Araraj** | Bihar |
| **Rampurva** | Bihar |
| **Rummindei** | Lumbini, Nepal |
| **Nigali Sagar** | Nepal |
| **Allahabad** (इलाहाबाद) | from **Kaushambi**, UP |
| **Delhi-Topra** | from Topra, Haryana |
| **Delhi-Meerut** | from **Meerut, UP** |

## 7.11 Cave Architecture of Mauryan Period

| Cave | Hill | Patron | Fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Sudama** | Barabar | Ashoka, 12th year | Polished cell; Ajivika |
| **Lomas Rishi** | Barabar | (facade; no Ashokan text) | **Horseshoe chaitya-arch** — prototype of Bhaja/Karle/Ajanta fronts |
| **Vishvakarma (Visva Zopri)** | Barabar | Ashoka | Ajivika |
| **Karan Chaupar** | Barabar | Ashoka, 19th year | Rain-retreat for Ajivikas |
| **Gopika, Vapiyaka, Vadathika** | Nagarjuni | **Dasharatha** | Still **Ajivika** (आजीविक) |

## 7.15 Provincial Administration

| Province | HQ | Governor |
|---|---|---|
| **Prachyapatha** / Magadha core | **Pataliputra** | King |
| **Uttarapatha** | **Taxila** | Kumara |
| **Avantiratha / Avantirashtra** | **Ujjain** | Kumara |
| **Kalinga** (after 261) | **Tosali** (+ **Samapa**) | Kumara / mahamatra |

| Province | HQ | Governor |
|---|---|---|
| **Dakshinapatha** (दक्षिणापथ) | **Suvarnagiri** | Kumara |

## 7.16 Revenue Administration

| Levy | Fact |
|---|---|
| **Bhaga** | Produce share; Arthashastra **1/6** (*shadbhaga*) |
| **Bali** | Extra / religious levy; **Rummindei drops it** |
| **Hiranya** | Cash |
| **Shulka** | Toll / customs (*sulkadhyaksha*) |
| **Vishti** (विष्टि -) | Forced labour |
| **Udakabhaga** | Irrigation cess |
| **Pranaya** | Emergency / benevolence tax (**UKPCS 2021**) |
| **Sita** | Crown-farm produce (*sitadhyaksha*) |
| **Vivit** | Pasture tax (*vivitadhyaksha*) |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| **Ahraura MRE** | **Mirzapur** (मिर्ज़ापुर) — UP's own Minor Rock Edict |
| Sarnath pillar / four-lion capital | Varanasi — **national emblem** |
| Schism edict | Sarnath + **Kaushambi** |
| Allahabad pillar | Originally **Kaushambi**; now Prayagraj (Ashoka + Gupta + Jahangir) |
| Meerut pillar | Origin **Meerut** (मेरठ); Firoz Shah moved it to Delhi |
| Sankissa elephant capital | Farrukhabad belt |
| Kashi–Kosala–Vatsa | Inside the **imperial core**, not a kumara-province |
| Kushinagar | Mauryan-period Buddhist site (Malla); not an edict site |
| Birth story | Magadha / Moriya; **not** "Ashoka of UP" |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **RE XII vs XIII** → XII = synthesis (2022); XIII = Kalinga.
2. **Rahulovada = Ashoka's dhamma definition** → **false** (2024).
3. **Agronomai = roads / weights** → **revenue** (2020); roads are the Strabo extra.
4. **Maski = Girnar Major set** → Maski = **MRE** that **names** Ashoka.
5. **Sannidhata collects tax** → he **stores**; Samaharta collects.
6. **Chandragupta Maurya = Chandragupta II** → 322 BCE vs Gupta.
7. **Barabar = Buddhist Ajanta / 6th c. BCE** → **Ajivika**, Mauryan polish.
8. **Sarnath lions = Sanchi stupa** → emblem = **Sarnath**; "best stupa" often = **Sanchi**.
9. **Megasthenes with Alexander** → Seleucus's envoy.
10. **Indica's seven castes = varna** → Greek seven-fold sketch; philosophers = Brahman + Shramana.
11. **Chola/Pandya / Sri Lanka = Mauryan provinces** → **neighbours** in RE II.
12. **Vayu Purana = Gupta administration** → 2023 stmt 2 false.

13. **Ashoka's death = end of empire** → lasts to **185** (Brihadratha).
14. **Arthashastra = Indica** → Kautilya vs Megasthenes.
15. **Allahabad pillar is only Gupta** → Mauryan shaft, later reused.
16. **Dhauli/Jaugada print full RE XIII** → they carry **separate Kalinga edicts** instead.
17. **Punch-marked coins = Ashoka's portrait issues** → anonymous *karshapana*; portraits = Indo-Greek.
18. **Didarganj Yakshi = Gupta Sarnath Buddha** → Mauryan-polish Patna figure (date debated).
19. **Prinsep 1837** reads Brahmi; Maski later proves Piyadassi = Ashoka.
20. **PE V = dhamma-mahamatras** → that is **RE V**; PE V = **animals**.
21. **Ahraura = Sarnath lions** → Ahraura = **Mirzapur MRE**.
22. **Lomas Rishi donated by Ashoka in writing** → famous **facade**; Sudama/Karan Chaupar carry Ashokan Ajivika grants.
23. **Bhabru Laghulovada proves 2024 stmt 1** → listed as a *monk-text*, not the definition of state Dhamma.
24. **Indica "no slavery" = Arthashastra** → they **clash**.
25. **Six city boards = six army boards = 18 tirthas** → three different lists.
26. **Girnar is only Ashokan** → same rock later has **Rudradaman**.
27. **Vaishali pillar carries the seven PE** → single lion, **no** edict.
28. **Chola/Keralaputra = kumara provinces** → **neighbours** (RE II).
29. **Kunala is as epigraphic as Tivala** → Tivala is on the Queen's edict; Kunala is legend.
30. **Pranaya = ordinary land tax** → **emergency** tax (UKPCS 2021).
31. **Sita = goddess in revenue stems** → crown-land produce.
32. **Turamaya = Syria** → **Egypt** (Ptolemy II).
33. **Mauryas started religious land grants** → Satavahana epigraphy; Mauryas did not.
34. **Vishnugupta = Vishakhadatta** → Chanakya's other name.
35. **Sudarshana founded by Rudradaman** → built under **Chandragupta**; Rudradaman **repairs**.
36. **Third Council = Ashokan edicts** → *Dipavamsa / Mahavamsa*.
37. **Parkham Yaksha unnamed** → inscribed **Manibhadra**.
38. **Kumrahar / Bulandibagh = Vaishali** → **Pataliputra**.

# Topic 8 — Post-Mauryan India

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Indo-Greek | Shaka | Hellenistic **Menander** vs Central Asian **Maues / Rudradaman** | इंडो-ग्रीक / शक |
| Shaka | Kushan | After Greeks, before Kushan vs **Kanishka** empire | शक / कुषाण |
| Shunga | Satavahana | Magadha **north** vs Deccan **Andhra** | शुंग / सातवाहन |
| Kharavela | Rudradaman | **Hathigumpha** Kalinga vs **Junagadh** Shaka | खारवेल / रुद्रदामन |
| Ayodhya inscription | Besnagar pillar | Pushyamitra **ashwamedha** vs Heliodorus **Bhagavata** | अयोध्या / बेसनगर |
| Vikrama 57 BCE | Shaka 78 CE | Traditional Vikramaditya vs **Kanishka-era** count | विक्रम / शक |
| Karikala | Rajaraja I | Sangam Chola, **Kallanai** vs imperial Chola, **Thanjavur** | करिकाल / राजराज |
| Mahendravarman I | Rajaraja I | **Pallava** vs **Chola** (2025 swap trap) | महेन्द्रवर्मन / राजराज |
| Kadungon | Amoghavarsha I | **Pandya** revival vs **Rashtrakuta** | कडुंगों / अमोघवर्ष |
| Akam | Puram | Inner **love** poetry vs outer **war / kingship** | अकम् / पुरम् |
| Gandhara art | Amaravati art | Kushan NW Greco-Buddhist vs Satavahana **Andhra** limestone | गांधार / अमरावती |
| Sangam Chola | Imperial Chola | Karikala age vs 9th–11th c. revival | संगम चोल / साम्राज्य चोल |
| Muvendar | Satavahana | Chera-Chola-Pandya vs north-Deccan **Andhra** house | मुवेन्दर / सातवाहन |
| Nahapana | Rudradaman | Kshaharata, beaten by Gautamiputra vs Kardamaka, Junagadh | नहपान / रुद्रदामन |
| Purushapura | Mathura | Kushan **main** capital vs **second** Indian capital | पुरुषपुर / मथुरा |
| Vaigai (Pandya) | Vengi (Andhra) | Madurai Pandya river vs Eastern Chalukya capital **Pedavegi** near **Eluru** | वैगई / वेंगी |
| Arikamedu / Poduke | Tamralipti | Coromandel Roman station vs Ganga-mouth Bay port | अरिकामेडु / ताम्रलिप्ति |
| Muvendar | Pallava / Kadamba | Sangam trio only vs later Kanchi / Vanavasi houses | मुवेन्दर / पल्लव–कदम्ब |

## Books and Writers — Post-Mauryan Age

| Book / text | Writer / authority | Horizon / use |
|---|---|---|
| *Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य) | **Patanjali** (पतंजलि) | Shunga-age grammar; **not** Kanishka's court |
| *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्) | **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) | Play on Agnimitra (अग्निमित्र) (Pushyamitra's son); Shunga setting |
| *Gatha Saptasati* | **Hala** | Prakrit anthology; Satavahana court |
| *Milinda Panha* | Dialogue of **Menander (Milinda)** and **Nagasena** | Indo-Greek Buddhist Q&A |
| *Buddhacharita* | **Ashvaghosha** | Buddha's life epic; Kanishka age |
| *Saundarananda* | **Ashvaghosha** | Same court circle |
| *Sariputraprakarana* | **Ashvaghosha** | Same court circle |
| *Tolkappiyam* | Tolkappiyar tradition | Earliest Tamil grammar and poetics; Sangam age |
| *Silappadikaram* | **Ilango Adigal** | Kannagi–Kovalan epic; later Sangam edge |
| *Manimekalai* (மணிமேகலை) | **Sattanar** (சத்தனார்) | Buddhist sequel to Silappadikaram |

| Book / text | Writer / authority | Horizon / use |
|---|---|---|
| *Tirukkural* (*Kural* / Muppal) | **Tiruvalluvar** | Called Laghuveda / Bible of Tamil ethics |
| *Ramavataram* | **Kamban** | Tamil Ramayana (later medieval Tamil classic) |
| *Periplus of the Erythraean Sea* | **Anonymous** Greek merchant | Red Sea / Indian Ocean trade handbook; Poduke = Arikamedu |
| *Matsya Purana* | Puranic tradition | Longest Andhra / Satavahana king list (~30) |
| *Vayu Purana* | Puranic tradition | Kanva end / Andhra founder memory |

## 8.2 Satavahana Rulers

### Gautamiputra Satakarni vs Nahapana — Cause, Course, Result

| Ruler | Fact |
|---|---|
| **Simuka** | Traditional founder after Kanva Susharma |
| **Satakarni I** | Early expansion; **Naneghat** of queen **Naganika** |
| **Gautamiputra Satakarni** | Greatest; defeats **Nahapana**; **Ekabrahmana** / varna protector; **Nasik** of **Gautami Balashri** |
| **Vashishthiputra Pulumavi** | Son and successor |
| **Hala** | *Gatha Saptasati* in Prakrit |
| **Yajna Sri Satakarni** | **Ship** on coins — sea-trade fact |

## 8.3 South Indian History

### Megalithic south

- **Megalithic** cultures are Iron Age burial traditions of the peninsula and parts of central India.
- They predate and underlie the Sangam polities.
- Burial types include **dolmens**, **cists**, stone circles, capstones, and **hero stones (virakkal / nadukal)** for warriors.
- Pottery is often **black-and-red ware (BRW)**.
- Iron tools and weapons appear in the graves.
- Major sites include **Brahmagiri**, **Adichanallur**, **Maski**, **Hallur**, **Nevasa**, and **Piklihal**.
- Brahmagiri links megalithic layers to early historic transitions.
- **PGW** is Later Vedic **doab** (दोआब) ware. **Megaliths** are mainly **south and Deccan** Iron Age burials.
- Grave goods can include pottery, iron weapons, gold, and beads.
- Some sites show communal or family burials under large stone slabs.

## 8.3b Post-Mauryan Art Schools — Quick Compare

| School | Period / patron | Material / style | Key fact |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Gandhara** | Kushan northwest | Greco-Buddhist **green schist** | Greco-Roman Buddha face; Indo-Greek bridge |
| **Mathura** | Kushan / local | Red sandstone Indian types | Indigenous Buddha forms |
| **Amaravati** | Satavahana Andhra | Limestone narrative reliefs | Andhra Buddhist stupa art |
| **Karle / Nasik** | Satavahana age | Rock-cut **chaitya** (चैत्य) halls | Public Buddhist architecture |

## 8.9 Sangam Age

| Sangam | Place | President / tradition |
|---|---|---|
| **First** | **Madurai** | Saint **Agastya** (with **Tolkappiyar** in some lists) |
| **Second** | **Kapadapuram** | Saint **Agastya** |
| **Third** | **Madurai** | **Nakkirar** |

| Kingdom | Emblem | Capital | Port | Famous king |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Chera** | Bow | **Vanji / Vanchi / Karur (Karuvur)** | **Muziris (Muchiri)**; also **Tondi** | **Senguttuvan**; **Udiyanjiral** (early Chera) |
| **Chola** | Tiger | **Uraiyur** | **Puhar / Kaveripattinam** | **Karikala** |
| **Pandya** | Fish | **Madurai** | **Korkai** | **Nedunjeliyan** |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| Ayodhya ashwamedha inscription | Ayodhya — Pushyamitra fact |
| Mathura | Kushan **second capital**. Mathura art |
| Sarnath | Not the Pushyamitra ashwamedha record |
| Deep-south Sangam | Not a UP polity. Ports are Tamilakam |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Kushans before Shakas** (2023 B) → Greeks → Sakas → Kushans.
2. **Hathigumpha = Ashoka / Kanishka / Harsha → Kharavela**.
3. **Pushyamitra ashwamedha = Besnagar / Hathigumpha → Ayodhya**.
4. **Satavahanas = Sanskrit-first / gold coins → Prakrit**; metals include lead/copper/silver/potin, **not gold**.
5. **Karikala = Rajaraja I** → Sangam vs imperial Chola.
6. **Mahendravarman = Chola → Pallava** (2025).
7. **Rajaraja = Pallava → Chola**.
8. **Shaka era = 57 BCE → 78 CE**; Vikrama = 57 BCE; difference **135**.
9. **Patanjali = Kanishka court → Shunga** / *Mahabhashya*.
10. **Rabatak lists Shravasti** → Saketa, Kaushambi, Pataliputra, Champa — **not Shravasti**.
11. **Sudarshana founded by Rudradaman** → built under Chandragupta; repaired **without forced labour**.
12. **Vima = copper only / Kujula = gold** → reverse: Vima = gold; Kujula = copper.
13. **Milinda contemporary of Bimbisara** → Indo-Greek, centuries later.
14. **Strato II = silver only** → remembered for **lead**.
15. **Satavahana capital = only Amaravati** → lasting capital **Pratishthana**.
16. **Ekabrahmana = Pushyamitra → Gautamiputra Satakarni**.
17. **Kushan navy explains Red Sea trade** → trade yes; navy claim false.
18. **Gandhara = red sandstone → green schist**; Mathura = red sandstone.
19. **Hathigumpha = Khandagiri → Udayagiri** (18 caves); Khandagiri has 15.
20. **Yaudheya coins = Vasudeva → Kartikeya** + peacock.
21. **Kadungon = Rashtrakuta → Pandya**.
22. **Milinda's monk = Nagarjuna → Nagasena**.
23. **Gondophares = Kushan → Parthian**.

24. **Purushapura = Mathura** → Peshawar main; Mathura second.
25. **Muvendar includes Pallava** → Chera, Chola, Pandya only.
26. **Akam = war** → Akam = love; Puram = war.
27. **Junagadh = Hathigumpha** → Gujarat Shaka vs Odisha Kalinga.
28. **Simuka = Kushan founder** → Satavahana; Kushan founder = **Kujula**.
29. **Fourth Council = Ashoka** → **Kanishka** / Kashmir; Ashoka = Third.
30. **Heliodorus = Pushyamitra's ashwamedha clerk** → Bhagavata envoy of Antialcidas.
31. **Sangam = Satavahana dynasty** → Tamil literary age; different house.
32. **Kon / Ko / Mannan = minister → king**.
33. **Third Sangam president = Agastya** → **Nakkirar**; First/Second = Agastya tradition.
34. **Yavanapriya = muslin / ivory** → **pepper**.
35. **Poduke = Tamralipti** → **Arikamedu**.
36. **Uraiyur = pepper / Pandya capital** → Sangam **Chola** capital and **cotton** centre.
37. **Kadamba / Pallava = Sangam Muvendar** → Chera, Chola, Pandya only.
38. **Vattakirutal = peaceful court debate** → defeated king's **fast unto death**.
39. **Pandya river = Godavari / Krishna Vengi** → **Vaigai** core (MCQ "Vengi" ≠ Eastern Chalukya Vengi).
40. ***Tolkappiyam* = astronomy / law code** → **grammar and poetry**.
41. ***Silappadikaram* = Sattanar** → **Ilango Adigal**; Sattanar = *Manimekalai*.
42. ***Kural* = Greek / Telugu** → **Tamil**; Laghuveda / Muppal by Tiruvalluvar.

# Topic 9 — Gupta Age

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Chandragupta I | Chandragupta II | Licchavi marriage founder vs **Vikramaditya**, Shaka war | प्रथम / द्वितीय |
| Chandragupta II | Chandragupta Maurya | Gupta ~380 CE vs Mauryan **322 BCE** | गुप्त / मौर्य |
| Samudragupta | Chandragupta II | **Digvijaya** / Prayag vs Shaka silver + Fa-Hien | समुद्रगुप्त / चंद्रगुप्त II |
| Prayag Prashasti | Allahabad pillar | Harishena's **text** vs the **shaft** it sits on | प्रशस्ति / स्तंभ |
| Gold dinara | Silver rupaka | Prestige types vs **2022 Shaka-victory** proof (~33 grains) | दीनार / रूपक |
| Bhukti | Vishaya | Province (**Uparika**) vs district (**Kumaramatya**) | भुक्ति / विषय |
| Kalidasa | Bhartrihari | *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत) / *Raghuvamsa* (रघुवंश) vs **Shringara Shataka** (शृंगार शतक) (2025) | कालिदास / भर्तृहरि |
| Fa-Hien | Hiuen Tsang | CG II ~400 CE vs **Harsha** ~630s | फाह्यान / ह्वेन त्सांग |
| Kumaragupta I | Skandagupta | **Nalanda** patron vs **Huna** wars (Bhitari) | कुमारगुप्त / स्कंदगुप्त |
| Somadeva | Kshemendra | *Kathasaritsagara* vs *Brihatkathamanjari* (2025) | सोमदेव / क्षेमेन्द्र |
| Jayadeva | Trivikrama Bhatta | *Gita Govinda* vs *Nala Champu* (2025) | जयदेव / त्रिविक्रम |
| Aryabhata | Varahamihira | *Aryabhatiya*, rotation vs *Brihatsamhita* | आर्यभट / वराहमिहिर |
| Sarnath Buddha | Gandhara Buddha | Gupta **plain drape** vs Kushan Greco-Buddhist | सारनाथ / गांधार |
| Sandhivigrahika | Samaharta | Gupta peace-and-war minister vs Mauryan collector | संधिविग्रहिक / समाहर्ता |
| Nalanda | Takshashila | Gupta **Kumaragupta I** vs older **Gandhara** town | नालंदा / तक्षशिला |
| Vikramashila | Vallabhi | Pala **Dharmapala** vs Maitraka **Gujarat** (also Jain council) | विक्रमशिला / वल्लभी |
| Gold dinara | Silver rupaka | Prestige types vs **Shaka-victory** proof (~33 grains) | दीनार / रूपक |
| Dhanvantari | Bhaskara II | Navaratna medicine vs **12th-c.** *Lilavati* | धन्वंतरि / भास्कर |
| Eran sati | Junagadh | **Goparaja** widow ~510 CE vs Rudradaman / Skandagupta lake texts | एरण सती / जूनागढ़ |
| Tamralipti | Bhrigukachchha | East Bengal port vs west **Bharuch** port | ताम्रलिप्ति / भृगुकच्छ |
| Pravarasena I | Prabhavatigupta | Vakataka **Samrat** / 4 ashvamedhas vs Gupta **princess-regent** | प्रवरसेन / प्रभावती |
| Devagupta | Chandragupta Maurya | CG II alias vs Mauryan founder | देवगुप्त / मौर्य |
| Vishti | Bhaga | Forced labour as tax vs produce share (~1/6) | विष्टि / भाग |

## Books and Writers — Gupta Age

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्), *Vikramorvashiyam* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्) | **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) | Gupta dramas (नाटक); CG II court tradition |
| *Raghuvamsa* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव) | **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) | Mahakavyas (महाकाव्य) |
| *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार) | **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) | Lyrics (गीतिकाव्य) |

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) | **Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि) | Not Kalidasa |
| *Amarakosha* (अमरकोश) | **Amarasimha** (अमरसिंह) | Lexicon; Navaratna name |
| *Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्) | **Sudraka** (शूद्रक) | Charudatta (चारुदत्त)–Vasantasena (वसन्तसेना) |
| *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस), *Devichandraguptam* (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्) | **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) | Chanakya play; Ramagupta story |
| *Kamasutra* (कामसूत्र) | **Vatsyayana** (वात्स्यायन) | Gupta-age Sanskrit treatise |
| *Panchatantra* (पंचतंत्र) | **Vishnu Sharma** (विष्णु शर्मा) (tradition) | Fable cycle |
| *Kiratarjuniya* (किरातार्जुनीय) | **Bharavi** (भारवि) | Late Gupta / after |
| *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय) | **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) | 499 CE; maths / astronomy |
| *Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका), *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता) | **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) | Astronomy / encyclopaedia |
| *Brahmasphutasiddhanta* (ब्रह्मस्फुटसिद्धान्त) | **Brahmagupta** (ब्रह्मगुप्त) | Early 7th c. edge of the age |
| *Setubandha* (सेतुबन्ध) (*Ravanavaho* (रावणवहो)) | **Pravarasena II** (प्रवरसेन द्वितीय) | Vakataka Prakrit |
| Prayag Prashasti (प्रयाग प्रशस्ति) | **Harishena** (हरिषेण) | Samudragupta's literary eulogy |
| *Nala Champu* (नल चम्पू) | **Trivikrama Bhatta** (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट) | Later match pair |
| *Kathasaritsagara* (कथासरित्सागर) | **Somadeva** (सोमदेव) | Later match pair |
| *Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद) | **Jayadeva** (जयदेव) | Later match pair |
| *Brihatkathamanjari* (बृहत्कथामंजरी) | **Kshemendra** (क्षेमेन्द्र) | Later match pair |

## 9.3 Samudragupta's Military Campaigns

### South kings often matched

| King | Kingdom |
|---|---|
| **Dhananjaya** (धनंजय) | **Kusthalapura** |
| **Nilaraja** | **Avamukta** |
| **Ugrasena** (उग्रसेन) | **Palaka / Palakka** |
| **Vishnugopa** | **Kanchi** |

### North, frontier, and gana tribute

- North names in the uprooted set include Ganapatinaga, **Nagasena** (नागसेन), **Achyuta**, **Chandravarman**, and **Balavarman**.
- Frontier tribute includes Samatata, **Davaka**, **Kamarupa**, **Nepala**, and **Karttripura**.
- Ganarajya tribute includes Malava, **Yaudheya**, **Arjunayana**, and **Madraka**.

> **Logic:** South = **tribute and restore**. North = **uproot**. Vishnugopa ≠ a Magadha king.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q87]:** Allahabad Prasasti (Prayag) of Samudragupta identifies contemporary kings: Dhananjaya = Kusthalapur; Nilraja = Avamukta; Damana = Erandapalla; Vishnugopa = Kanchi. *(See Q4 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

## 9.8 Gupta Administration System

| Level | Unit | Officer |
|---|---|---|
| Empire | | Maharajadhiraja |
| Province | **Bhukti** | **Uparika** |
| District | **Vishaya** | **Kumaramatya** / **Ayuktaka** |
| Sub-district | **Vithi** | local notables / *vithi-mahattara* |
| Village | **Grama** | **Gramika** / *ashtakuladhikarana* |

## 9.9 Gupta Inscriptions

| Record | Ruler | Fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Prayag Prashasti** | Samudragupta | Harishena. Campaigns in 9.3 |
| **Allahabad pillar** (इलाहाबाद स्तंभ) | (the shaft) | Ashoka + prashasti in 9.14 |
| **Mehrauli iron pillar** | Chandra = CG II in most keys | Rust-resistant iron |
| **Bhitari pillar** | **Skandagupta** | **Huna** war; Ghazipur, UP |
| **Udayagiri** | CG II / Kumaragupta | Vaishnava caves |
| **Eran** | Samudragupta / later Buddhagupta–Bhanugupta | Varaha; **sati** of Goparaja's widow (~510 CE) |
| **Damodarpur plates** | Later imperial Guptas | Kumaramatya. Land grants |
| **Mandasor / Dashpur** | Kumaragupta age / silk weavers | Sun temple; Bandhuvarman. Yashodharman's later Huna boast is a different Mandasor text |

## 9.11 Gupta Gold Coins

| Type | Usual king |
|---|---|
| King and queen (Kumaradevi) | **Chandragupta I** |
| Ashvamedha horse | **Samudragupta** |
| Lyrist / veena | **Samudragupta** |
| Battle-axe / *parashu* | **Samudragupta** |
| Tiger-slayer (*vyaghra*) | **Samudragupta** |
| Standard / Garuda types | **Samudragupta** (in the famous six-type set) |
| Archer | **Chandragupta II** (commonest) |
| Chhatra / lion-slayer | **Chandragupta II** |
| Lion-slayer / peacock | **Kumaragupta I** |
| King fighting lion | **Skandagupta** |

## 9.15 Nalanda University

| University | Region | Founder / patron fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Takshashila** | Gandhara | Pre-Mauryan teaching town; Panini grammar |
| **Nalanda** | Bihar | **Kumaragupta I** founder-patron |

| University | Region | Founder / patron fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Vikramashila** | Bengal–Bihar belt | **Pala Dharmapala** |
| **Vallabhi** | Gujarat | **Maitraka**; Jain Svetambara council |

## 9.17 Gupta Literature

### Navaratnas (later tradition)

| Gem | Field |
|---|---|
| **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) | Poetry and drama |
| **Amarasimha** (अमरसिंह) | *Amarakosha* (अमरकोश) (lexicon) |
| **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) | Astronomy (*Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका), *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता)) — actually **6th century** |
| **Dhanvantari** (धन्वंतरि) | Medicine |
| **Vararuchi** (वररुचि) | Grammar |
| **Ghatakarpara** (घटकर्पर) | Poetry |
| **Kshapanaka** (क्षपणक) | Astrology |
| **Shanku** (शंकु) | Architecture |
| **Vetala Bhatta** (वेताल भट्ट) | Magic / counsel |

| Writer | Book |
|---|---|
| **Trivikrama Bhatta** (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट) | **Nala Champu** (नल चम्पू) |
| **Somadeva** (सोमदेव) | **Kathasaritsagara** (कथासरित्सागर) |
| **Jayadeva** (जयदेव) | **Gita Govinda** (गीत गोविंद) |
| **Kshemendra** (क्षेमेन्द्र) | **Brihatkathamanjari** (बृहत्कथामंजरी) |

## 9.21 Ancient Universities — Full Four-Way Card

| University | Region | Patron / age | Subjects & facts | End / trap |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Takshashila (Taxila)** | Gandhara (NW) | Pre-Mauryan; **Chanakya**, **Panini** | Grammar, medicine, politics | Damaged by **Hunas** (~5th c.) |
| **Nalanda** | Bihar | **Kumaragupta I**; Pala peak | Buddhist philosophy, logic; Xuanzang studied here | **Bakhtiyar Khalji** ~1193 |
| **Vikramashila** | Bhagalpur belt | **Pala Dharmapala** (~8th c.) | Mahayana, Tantra; **Atisa** taught here | Destroyed ~12th c. |
| **Vallabhi** | Gujarat | **Maitraka** rulers | Brahmanical + Jain; **Svetambara Jain council** (~5th c.) | Not Vaishali; not Buddhist 2nd council |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| Allahabad / Prayag pillar | Prayagraj — Ashoka + Karuvaki + Harishena + Jahangir |
| Bhitari Huna pillar | **Ghazipur**, UP — Skandagupta |
| Bhitargaon brick temple | Kanpur belt |
| Sarnath Gupta Buddha | Varanasi |

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| Kaushambi origin of the Allahabad shaft | Kaushambi |
| Fa-Hien's Ganga plain | includes the UP stretch of the empire |
| Eran sati / Varaha | Madhya Pradesh (not UP) — still a must-score inscription |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Chandragupta II = Chandragupta Maurya** → Gupta Vikramaditya vs 322 BCE.
2. **2022 Shaka proof = gold dinara** → **silver**, ~33 grains.
3. **33 grains = gold weight** → silver rupaka.
4. **Samudragupta annexed the south** → restored **tributes**.
5. **Vishnugopa = Magadha** → **Kanchi**.
6. **Dhananjaya = Avamukta** → **Kusthalapura**. Nilaraja = Avamukta.
7. **Prayag Prashasti = the pillar itself** → the **text**. Shaft is Ashokan.
8. **Shringara Shataka = Kalidasa** → **Bhartrihari** (2025).
9. **Fa-Hien = Hiuen Tsang** → ~400 vs ~630. 2024 order Fa-Hien first.
10. **Nalanda = Fa-Hien's main campus memoir** → founder fact **Kumaragupta**. Xuanzang = later.
11. **Vayu Purana = Gupta admin** → 2023 stmt 2 false.
12. **Sarnath Buddha = Gandhara** → Gupta vs Kushan.
13. **Ajanta = default Gupta court painting** → largely **Vakataka**.
14. **Jayadeva sat with Kalidasa** → 2025 match only. Later poet.
15. **Bhitari = Samudragupta south list** → **Skandagupta / Hunas**.
16. **Sandhivigrahika = Samaharta** → Gupta war-peace vs Mauryan collector.
17. **King-queen gold = Chandragupta II Shaka type** → **Chandragupta I** + Kumaradevi.
18. **Lyrist coin = Chandragupta II** → **Samudragupta**.
19. **Allahabad pillar is only Gupta** → Mauryan shaft reused.
20. **Maukhari pairs treated as imperial Gupta** → Ishanavarman / Jivitagupta II are **later**. **Sarvavarman ≠ Gaya** plate.
21. **Chapter starts at Chandragupta II** → Sri Gupta → Ghatotkacha → **Chandragupta I** first.
22. **Ramagupta = hard inscription king** → play-trap (*Devichandraguptam*).
23. **Devagupta = Chandragupta Maurya** → Devagupta is an alias of **Chandragupta II**.
24. **Lilavati = Dhanvantari / Gupta maths** → **Bhaskara II**, 12th century.
25. **Bhitari = outside UP** → **Ghazipur**, Uttar Pradesh.
26. **Admin ladder skips Vithi** → Bhukti → Vishaya → **Vithi** → Grama.
27. **Eran sati = Rudradaman** → Goparaja's widow ~510 CE.
28. **Tamralipti = only west port** → east Bengal; west = **Bharuch**.
29. **Pravarasena I = four ashvamedhas of Samudragupta** → **Vakataka** king.
30. **Mehrauli = Ashoka pillar only** → iron **Vishnu dhvaja** of Chandra / CG II.

# Topic 10 — Post-Gupta Period

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Gupta | Post-Gupta | Imperial ~320–550 vs fragment then **Harsha** | गुप्त / उत्तर-गुप्त |
| Thanesar | Kannauj | Early capital **Haryana** vs later capital **UP** | थानेसर / कन्नौज |
| Banabhatta | Kalidasa | Harsha's **prose** vs Gupta **poetry/drama** | बाणभट्ट / कालिदास |
| Harshacharita | Kadambari | Harsha **biography** vs **romance** (same Bana) | हर्षचरित / कादम्बरी |
| Harshacharita | Si-Yu-Ki | Sanskrit kavya vs Xuanzang's **Chinese** record | हर्षचरित / सी-यू-की |
| Fa-Hien | Hiuen Tsang | CG II ~400 vs Harsha **~630** | फाह्यान / ह्वेन त्सांग |
| Hiuen Tsang | I-Tsing | Harsha's guest vs **after** Harsha, still Nalanda | ह्वेन त्सांग / इ-त्सिंग |
| Pulakeshin II | Shashanka | **Narmada** Chalukya stop vs **Gauda** who killed the brother | पुलकेशिन / शशांक |
| Maukhari | Pushyabhuti | Kannauj house vs **Thanesar** house | मौखरी / पुष्यभूति |
| Ishanavarman | Ishvaravarman | **Haraha** 554 CE vs father. **Jaunpur** in 2022 key | ईशानवर्मन / ईश्वरवर्मन |
| Haraha | Gaya copper plate | Maukhari Ishanavarman vs **Samudragupta** plate (2022 trap) | हराहा / गया |
| Harsha | Kharavela | 7th c. Kannauj vs **Hathigumpha** (2018 trap C) | हर्ष / खारवेल |
| Mathura cotton | Varanasi silk | Xuanzang textile pair | मथुरा कपास / वाराणसी रेशम |
| Kausheya | Cotton | Silk cloth word vs ordinary cotton | कौशेय / कपास |
| Hundi | Royal edict | Bill of exchange vs king's order | हुंडी / आज्ञा |
| Sung-yun | Fa-Hien | ~518 Wei envoy vs CG II pilgrim ~400 | सुंगयुन / फाह्यान |
| Harsha | Shankaracharya | 7th c. Kannauj king vs 8th c. Advaita maths | हर्ष / शंकर |

## Books and Writers — Post-Gupta / Harsha Age

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Harshacharita* | **Banabhatta** | Prose biography (*akhyayika*) of Harsha |
| *Kadambari* | **Banabhatta** (finished by **Bhushanabhatta**) | Prose romance (*katha*) |
| *Suryashataka* | **Mayura** | Same Harsha court; not Bana |
| *Nagananda*, *Ratnavali*, *Priyadarshika* | Attributed to **Harsha** | Court plays; *Nagananda* has Buddhist flavour |
| *Si-Yu-Ki* (*Xiyu Ji*) | **Hiuen Tsang / Xuanzang** | Chinese record of Harsha's India |
| *Nanhai Jigui Neifa Zhuan* | **I-tsing (Yijing)** | Post-Harsha Nalanda / sea-route account |
| *Kitab-ul-Hind* | **Al-Biruni** | ~1017; last in the usual traveller order |
| *Rajatarangini* | **Kalhana** (कल्हण) | Later Kashmir chronicle (Huna / Harsha-age memory) |

## 10.4 Policies of Harshavardhana

### South — Pulakeshin II (Cause, Course, Result)

**Cause:** Harsha pushed south from Kannauj and tried to cross into the Deccan.

**Course: Pulakeshin II** of **Vatapi** stopped him about **630–634 CE**. The **Aihole inscription** of **Ravikirti** on the **Meguti** temple records that boast. Some copper-plate readings push the clash toward **618 CE**; the stopper remains Pulakeshin II.

**Result:** The **Narmada** becomes Harsha's effective southern line. He never becomes a Deccan emperor.

## 10.14 Master Calendar & Eras Reference

| Era / Samvat | Starting Year | Founder / Association | Key Conversion Formula |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Kali Era** | **3102 BCE** | Traditional Mahabharata epoch | Ancient astronomical reckonings |
| **Vikrama Samvat (Krit / Malav)** | **57 / 58 BCE** | King Vikramaditya of Ujjain | Current Gregorian Year + 57 (e.g. 2026 + 57 = 2083) |
| **Saka Samvat** | **78 CE** | Kushana Emperor Kanishka | Current Gregorian Year - 78 (e.g. 2026 - 78 = 1948); difference with Vikrama is **135 years** |
| **Gupta Era** | **319 / 320 CE** | Chandragupta I | Reckoned from Chandragupta I's coronation |
| **Harsha Era** | **606 CE** | Harshavardhana | Accession of Harsha |

## 10.15 High-Yield Dynastic, Epigraphic & Cultural Spines

- **Center of Gravity:** Trade and political supremacy shifted from Ujjain to **Kannauj (Mahodaya / Mahodayashri)** on the fertile Ganga-Yamuna doab, triggering the tripartite struggle (Palas, Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas).
- **Maukharis of Kannauj:** Rose as feudatories of Guptas from Gaya; kings: Hari Varma, Aditya Varma, Ishana Varma (**Haraha inscription, 554 CE**), Sarva Varma (**Asirgarh copper seal**), Graha Varma (married Harsha's sister Rajyashri).
- **Harshavardhana (606–647 CE):**
- Pushyabhuti founder at Thanesar; Harsha made Kannauj joint capital with sister **Rajyashri**.
- Southern expedition checked by Chalukya **Pulakeshin II** on Narmada (Aihole inscription by Ravikirti, 618 / 634 CE).
- Held **Kannauj religious convention** (20 kings, presided by Hiuen Tsang) and **Prayag Mahamoksha Parishad** (every 5 years for dana/charity).
- Eastern ally: **Bhaskaravarman** of Kamarupa (Assam). Court poet **Banabhatta** born at Prithikuta on Son river (*Harshacharita*, *Kadambari*).
- **Chinese Travellers:**
- **Sungyun (518–521 CE):** Visited north India to collect Buddhist sutras.
- **Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang) (629–645 CE):** Wrote *Si-Yu-Ki*; studied at Nalanda under **Shilabhadra**; recorded ordeals by fire/water/poison; noted **Mathura** famous for cotton, **Varanasi** for silk (***Kausheya***).
- **I-tsing (671–695 CE):** Came via Sumatra sea route; stayed in Bihar collecting vinaya texts.
- Chinese called India ***Yin-tu*** or ***Thian-tu***.
- **Economic & Cultural Locks:**
- ***Hundi***: Indigenous financial instrument / bill of exchange used for trade credit.
- **Feudal System:** Lord-vassal land-based administration without European serfdom; dominant in post-Gupta era.
- **Sun Temple at Multan / Sambapur:** Celebrated sun-worship shrine visited by Hiuen Tsang, Al-Masudi, Abu Zaid, and Al-Biruni.
- **Sondani Inscription:** Composed by **Vasula Kavi**, celebrating Aulikara king **Yashodharman's** defeat of Huna Mihirakula.

- **Adi Shankaracharya (8th c. CE):** Born at **Kaladi (Kerala)**; propounded **Advaita Vedanta**; established 4 monasteries: **Jyotirmath (North), Sringeri (South), Puri (East), Dwarka (West)**; established the 4 Dhams (Badrinath, Dwarka, Puri, Rameshwaram).
- **Nalanda Destruction:** Ransacked by **Bakhtiyar Khalji** in **1193 CE**, setting Buddhism in India on permanent decline.

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| Kannauj | Later Harsha capital |
| Haraha inscription | Barabanki — Ishanavarman |
| Jaunpur stone | Ishvaravarman in the 2022 key |
| Prayag charity | Prayagraj — Xuanzang |
| Pritikuta / Shravasti | Bana's home |
| Thanesar | **Haryana**. Not UP |
| Deo-Baranark | Bihar — Jivitagupta II. Not a UP site |
| Aphsad inscription | Bihar — Adityasena. Not a UP site |
| Banskhera plate | Shahjahanpur, UP — Harsha grant with signature |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Harsha = Gupta emperor** → Pushyabhuti / Vardhana.
2. **Thanesar = Kannauj** → early Haryana seat vs later **UP** capital.
3. **Thanesar is in UP** → **Haryana**.
4. **Fa-Hien visited Harsha** → Fa-Hien = Chandragupta II (~400).
5. **Hiuen Tsang = Fa-Hien** → ~630 vs ~400. 2024 order Fa-Hien first.
6. **I-Tsing sat in the 643 Kannauj assembly** → after Harsha.
7. **Nalanda founder = Xuanzang / Harsha** → **Kumaragupta I**. Xuanzang is the visitor.
8. **Sarvavarman issued the Gaya copper plate** → **2022 Q87 B**. Gaya plate = Gupta / Samudragupta. Sarvavarman = Asirgarh.
9. **Haraha = Sarvavarman** → **Ishanavarman**, Barabanki.
10. **Rajyashri married Dhruvasena II / Pulakeshin II** → **Grihavarman** only.
11. **Pulakeshin killed Rajyavardhana** → **Shashanka** of Gauda.
12. **Harsha conquered the Deccan** → **Narmada** stop. Aihole boast of Pulakeshin II.
13. **Aihole = Harsha's prasasti** → **Ravikirti** for Pulakeshin II.
14. **Harshacharita = Si-Yu-Ki** → Bana's Sanskrit vs Xuanzang's Chinese.
15. **Kadambari = second Harsha chronicle** → romance. *Harshacharita* is the biography.
16. **Bana = Kalidasa** → Harsha court vs Gupta court.
17. **2018 Hathigumpha = Harsha** → **Kharavela**.
18. **2025 Battle of Kannauj = Harsha** → Humayun / Sher Shah.
19. **Prayag charity = 1540 war** → quinquennial give-away Xuanzang saw.
20. **Uparika invented by Harsha** → Gupta provincial title reused.
21. **Mathura = silk, Varanasi = cotton in Xuanzang** → reverse the pair.
22. **Yin-tu = a Harsha capital** → Chinese name for **India**.
23. **Tripartite struggle = Harsha vs Pulakeshin** → later Pala–Pratihara–Rashtrakuta for Kannauj.

24. **Shankaracharya's four maths = Harsha foundations** → 8th-c. Advaita; not this file's core.
25. **Sung-yun = Fa-Hien under CG II** → ~518 Wei envoy, not Chandragupta II.

# Topic 11 — Ancient Indian Administration

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rajan | Maharajadhiraja | Vedic chief vs Gupta/Harsha **king of kings** | राजन / महाराजाधिराज |
| Devanampiya | Vikramaditya | Ashoka on edicts vs **Chandragupta II** | देवानंप्रिय / विक्रमादित्य |
| Sabha | Samiti | Smaller/elder council vs larger tribal assembly | सभा / समिति |
| Bhagadugha | Akshavapa | Vedic **revenue** vs **dice** (2023 C) | भागदुघ / अक्षावाप |
| Bhagadugha | Samaharta | Vedic share-collector vs Mauryan **chief** collector | भागदुघ / समाहर्ता |
| Samaharta | Sannidhata | Collects vs **stores** | समाहर्ता / संनिधाता |
| Agronomai | Pautavadhyaksha | Megasthenes **revenue** vs weights | एग्रोनोमाई / पौतवाध्यक्ष |
| Rajuka | Uparika | Mauryan district land/justice vs Gupta **province** | राजुक / उपरिक |
| Sandhivigrahika | Mahasandhivigrahika | Gupta war-peace vs Harsha's **maha-** grade | संधिविग्रहिक / महा- |
| Hathigumpha | Prayag Prashasti | **Kharavela** vs **Samudragupta** | हाथीगुम्फा / प्रयाग |
| Ayodhya inscription | Besnagar | Pushyamitra ashwamedha vs **Heliodorus** | अयोध्या / बेसनगर |
| Gaya copper plate | Asirgarh seal | **Samudragupta** plate vs Maukhari **Sarvavarman** | गया / असीरगढ़ |

## Books and Writers — Administration Sources

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Arthashastra* (अर्थशास्त्र) | **Kautilya / Chanakya** | Saptanga, adhyakshas, spies, revenue |
| *Indica* | **Megasthenes** (मेगस्थनीज) | Agronomai, city boards, seven classes |

## 11.1 Ancient Rulers

| Kind | Examples | use |
|---|---|---|
| **Literary** | Veda, Purana, Tripitaka, Sangam | doctrine, inflated king-lists |
| **Epigraphy** | edicts, Hathigumpha, Prayag, Nasik, Mehrauli | hardest dates and titles |
| **Numismatics** | punch-mark, Kushan gold, CG II silver | 2022 Shaka-victory proof |
| **Archaeology** | sites, C-14, PGW / NBPW / IVC | period, not a king's name |
| **Foreign accounts** | Megasthenes, Fa-Hien, Xuanzang, I-tsing | 2024 traveller order |

### Coins as administrative evidence

| Coin type | Period / issuer | What it proves |
|---|---|---|
| **Punch-marked silver** (*karshapana*) | Mahajanapada → Maurya | Urban trade, magistrate control, weight standard |
| **Mauryan cast copper** | Mauryan | State issue beyond silver punch-marks |
| **Indo-Greek portrait** | Menander etc. | Die-struck bilingual (Greek + Kharoshthi) kings |
| **Kushan gold** | Vima / Kanishka | Imperial titles, **Devaputra**, long-distance trade |
| **Satavahana lead / bronze** | Deccan | **Ship** types = sea trade; metronymic legends |
| **Gupta gold dinara** | Samudragupta → Skandagupta | Imperial titles; **Chandragupta II** silver = western **Shaka** victory |
| **Restruck Nahapana silver** | Gautamiputra age | Defeat of western Shaka overlord |

## 11.8 Foreign Accounts on Ancient Administration

| Traveller | Age | Admin observation |
|---|---|---|
| **Megasthenes** | Chandragupta Maurya | seven castes (Greek lens), agronomai, city boards |
| **Fa-Hien** | Chandragupta II | light punishments, Buddhist patronage visible |
| **Hiuen Tsang** | Harsha | good roads, hospices; elephant numbers = colour |
| **I-tsing** | Post-Harsha | monastic rules at Nalanda |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| Ayodhya inscription | Pushyamitra ashwamedha |
| Prayag / Allahabad shaft | Ashoka + Harishena |
| Haraha | Barabanki — Ishanavarman |
| Jaunpur stone | Ishvaravarman |
| Bhitari | Ghazipur belt — Skandagupta |
| Banskhera | Shahjahanpur — Harsha signature |
| Besnagar | **MP** — Heliodorus pillar |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Both statements always true** → read each stem; Rahulovada-type distractors flip one statement.
2. **Jivitagupta–Deo-Baranark is the wrong Maukhari pair** → the wrong pair in that match set is **Sarvavarman–Gaya**.
3. **Bhagadugha = gambling** → **Akshavapa**. Bhagadugha = revenue.
4. **Agronomai = roads / weights** → **revenue** (2020).
5. **Hathigumpha = Harsha / Ashoka / Kanishka** → **Kharavela**.
6. **Pushyamitra ashwamedha = Besnagar / Hathigumpha** → **Ayodhya**.
7. **Vikramaditya = Samudragupta** → **Chandragupta II**.
8. **Devanampiya = Gupta title** → **Ashoka**.
9. **Samaharta = treasurer** → **Sannidhata** stores. Samaharta collects.
10. **Uparika = Mauryan district** → Gupta/Harsha **province**.
11. **Gaya plate = Sarvavarman** → **Samudragupta**. Sarvavarman = Asirgarh.
12. **Start the Gupta line at Chandragupta II** → Sri Gupta → Ghatotkacha → **Chandragupta I**.
13. **Vayu Purana = Gupta admin** → 2023 stmt 2 false.
14. **Allahabad pillar is only Gupta** → Ashokan shaft reused.
15. **Aihole = Harsha's prasasti** → **Ravikirti** for Pulakeshin II.
16. **Guptas more central than Mauryas** → opposite.
17. **Dhananjaya = Avamukta** → **Kusthalapura**.
18. **Sabha = Mauryan board** → Vedic assembly.

# Topic 12 — Ancient Indian Economy

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Punch-marked | Gupta dinara | First **silver** coins vs later **gold** prestige | पंच-मार्क / दीनार |
| Dinara | Rupaka | Gupta **gold** vs CG II **silver** (~33 grains) | दीनार / रूपक |
| Nishka | Karshapana | Vedic gold **unit** vs punch-marked **coin** | निष्क / कार्षापण |
| Shreni | Manigrama | General craft guild vs **foreign** trade (2018) | श्रेणी / मणिग्राम |
| Nanadesi | Manigrama | Merchants of **many lands** vs overseas **Manigrama** | नानादेशी / मणिग्राम |
| Lothal | Muziris | Harappan **dock** vs Sangam–Roman **pepper** port | लोथल / मुज़िरिस |
| Barygaza | Barbarikon | **Broach** vs **Indus-mouth** in Periplus | भरूच / बारबारिकोन |
| Tamralipti | Broach | East Ganga mouth vs west Narmada mouth | ताम्रलिप्ति / भरूच |
| Uttarapatha | Dakshinapatha | NW–Ganga highway vs north–**Deccan** | उत्तरापथ / दक्षिणापथ |
| Port | Entrepot | Landing point vs **warehouse / redistributor** | बंदरगाह / एंट्रेपो |
| Urban | Pastoral | IVC (2020) vs **Rigvedic** | नगरीय / पशुपालक |

## Books and Writers — Economy Sources

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Periplus of the Erythraean Sea* | **Anonymous** Greek merchant | 1st c. CE sailing handbook; Barygaza / Muziris |
| Natural History (gold-drain note) | **Pliny** | Roman gold flowing to India |
| *Arthashastra* | **Kautilya** (कौटिल्य) | Guild custom, revenue, Mauryan economy |

## 12.1 Economy

### Match spine

- The Indus Valley economy is keyed as **urban**.
- The Rigvedic economy is keyed as **pastoral**.
- The Later Vedic economy is keyed as **agrarian**.
- The medieval slot in the 2020 match list is **landlordism**.

## 12.10 Punch-Marked Coins — Symbols and Janapadas

| Fact | Detail |
|---|---|
| Metal / name | Silver **karshapana** with several punch symbols |
| Issuers | First **mahajanapadas**, then Magadha–Maurya |
| Small change | Mauryan **cast copper** *kakani* |
| Style | Geometric / animal punches — **no royal portrait** |
| Portraits | Begin with **Indo-Greek** (इंडो-ग्रीक) die-struck coins |

## UP Focus

| Fact | Place |
|---|---|
| Varanasi | Inland textile / Ganga river-port |
| Kaushambi | Uttarapatha Ganga node |
| Kannauj | Later entrepot (Harsha age) |
| Alamgirpur | IVC east end. **Not** a sea-port |
| Lothal / Muziris | **Not** UP |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **First Indian coins = Gupta gold** → **punch-marked silver**.
2. **2022 Shaka proof = dinara** → **silver**, ~33 grains.
3. **33 grains = gold weight** → silver rupaka. Gold is ~120–144.
4. **King-queen gold = Chandragupta II** → **Chandragupta I**.
5. **Lyrist = Chandragupta II** → **Samudragupta**.
6. **Nishka = Mauryan coin** → Vedic gold **unit**.
7. **Shreni = 2018 foreign trade** → **Manigrama**.
8. **Shreni = only northern India** → north **and** south; quality/price/conduct are guild-controlled.
9. **Nanadesi = Manigrama** → many-lands vs overseas guild.
10. **Boat models = Dholavira** → **Mohenjo-daro + Lothal**.
11. **Barbarikon = Broach** → Indus mouth. Broach = **Barygaza**.
12. **Tamralipti = main Roman port** → **Muziris** / west-south.
13. **Lothal = Muziris** → Bronze Age dock vs Sangam–Roman pepper.
14. **IVC = pastoral** → **Urban** (2020). Pastoral = Rigvedic.
15. **Later Vedic = urban** → **agrarian**.
16. **Entrepot = any jetty** → warehouse / redistributor.
17. **Dakshinapatha = only sea** → inland north–Deccan road.
18. **Yavana = only a Greek king** → Sangam foreign / western trader.
19. **Only the first statement true** → check whether **both** statements hold before locking “Only 1”.

# Topic 13 — Archaeology

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Site | Excavation | Place with remains vs the **dig** | स्थल / उत्खनन |
| Stratigraphy | C-14 | Relative (layers) vs **calendar years** | स्तरिकी / कार्बन-14 |
| Relative | Absolute | Older/younger vs **5730-year** clock | सापेक्ष / निरपेक्ष |
| Marshall | Wheeler | Announces IVC **1924** vs grid dig **1946** | मार्शल / व्हीलर |
| Sahni | Banerjee | **Harappa 1921** vs **Mohenjo-daro 1922** | साहनी / बनर्जी |
| Wakankar | Sankalia | **Bhimbetka** vs Deccan prehistory | वाकणकर / संकलिया |
| Alamgirpur | Rakhigarhi | Easternmost **UP** vs largest **Haryana** | आलमगीरपुर / राखीगढ़ी |
| Mandi | Manda | **Muzaffarnagar UP** vs **J&K** Chenab | मंडी / मांडा |
| Hulas | Lothal | Baghpat **UP** vs Gujarat **dock** | हुलास / लोथल |
| Rock shelter | Cave | Bhimbetka overhang vs hollow | शैल आश्रय / गुफा |
| ASI HQ | Lucknow | **New Delhi** vs UP state archaeology | दिल्ली / लखनऊ |

## 13.5 Archaeological Sites

| Site | State |
|---|---|
| **Nevasa** | **Maharashtra** (Pravara) |
| **Isampur** | **Karnataka** (Acheulian) |
| **Didwana** | **Rajasthan** (थार) (Thar fringe) |
| **Gudiyam Cave** | **Tamil Nadu** |

## 13.6 Archaeological Sites of Uttar Pradesh

| Site | District / river | Fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Alamgirpur** | Meerut, **Hindon** | **Easternmost** IVC site in India |
| **Hulas** | Baghpat | UP Harappan; PYQs **2018, 2020, 2025** |
| **Mandi** | Bijnor, **Ramganga** (रामगंगा) | UP Harappan (2021, 2025) |
| Often used as bait | Actual location | |
| --- | --- | |
| **Manda** | Jammu and Kashmir | |
| **Rakhigarhi** | Haryana (largest IVC mound in India) | |
| **Kalibangan** | Rajasthan | |
| **Lothal** | Gujarat | |
| **Balu** | Haryana | |

## 13.7 Archaeological Cultures — Pottery and Metal Horizons

| Culture | Marker | Usual date / link |
|---|---|---|
| **OCP** (Ochre Coloured Pottery) | eastern doab pottery | Chalcolithic overlap; pairs with **copper hoards** |
| **PGW** (Painted Grey Ware) | grey painted bowls | **Later Vedic** north; Hastinapur, Atranjikhera |
| **NBPW** (Northern Black Polished Ware) | lustrous northern fine ware | ~6th c. BCE rise; **Mauryan** cities |
| **Megalithic** | burials with big stones | Iron-age **south**; not Harappan |

## 13.8 Major Excavation Sites — Signature Cards

| Site | State | Excavator / fact | Signature find |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Rakhigarhi** | Haryana | recent ASI digs | largest IVC mound in India; **not UP** |
| **Dholavira** | Gujarat | R.S. Bisht | reservoirs, **signboard**, stone architecture |
| **Kalibangan** | Rajasthan | B.B. Lal | ploughed field, fire altars |
| **Banawali** | Haryana | — | fortified Harappan town |
| **Surkotada** | Gujarat | — | Harappan fort; horse-bone debate |

## 13.9 Dating Methods — Beyond C-14

| Method | Samples | Fact |
|---|---|---|
| **Stratigraphy** | soil layers | relative order only |
| **Typology** | pottery shape | relative, cross-site |
| **Radiocarbon (C-14)** | charcoal, bone, seed | organic only; ~5730 yr half-life |
| **Thermoluminescence (TL)** | fired pottery, bricks | when object was last heated |

## UP Focus

| Trap | Fact |
|---|---|
| Bhimbetka in UP | **MP** |
| ASI HQ Lucknow | **New Delhi** |
| Sanauli = Mature Harappan dock | Late Harappan / OCP **chariots**, Baghpat |

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Rakhigarhi = UP** → **Haryana**. 2025 bait.
2. **Biggest IVC = eastern boundary** → east end is **Alamgirpur**.
3. **Mandi = Manda** → Bijnor UP vs **J&K**.
4. **Hulas = Gujarat** → **Baghpat, UP**. Padri is Gujarat.
5. **Kalibangan / Lothal = UP** → Rajasthan / Gujarat (2018).
6. **Wheeler discovered IVC** → Sahni + Banerjee under **Marshall 1924**. Wheeler = 1946 grid.
7. **Marshall dug every trench** → he is the **DG** who announced.
8. **Wakankar = Vatsa** → Vatsa is Harappan. Wakankar = **Bhimbetka**.
9. **Bhimbetka = UP** → **MP**.

10. **C-14 dates stone / copper** → **organic** only.
11. **ASI HQ = Lucknow** → **New Delhi**.
12. **Sanauli = Lothal dock** → Baghpat **chariots**, Late Harappan / OCP.
13. **Didwana = Tamil Nadu** → **Rajasthan**. Gudiyam = TN.
14. **Isampur = Maharashtra** → **Karnataka**. Nevasa = MH.
15. **Manda = eastern Harappan** → **north** (J&K). East = Alamgirpur.

# Topic 14 — Ancient India Miscellaneous

## Confused Pairs

| A | B | Difference | Hindi |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mesopotamia | Egypt | Two rivers + city-states vs **one Nile** + unified pharaoh | मेसोपोटामिया / मिस्र |
| Ziggurat | Pyramid | Stepped **temple** vs royal **tomb** | जिग्गुरात / पिरामिड |
| Cuneiform | Hieroglyphs | Clay wedges vs **picture** signs | कीलाक्षर / चित्रलिपि |
| Indus script | Oracle bones | Still **unread** vs earliest **readable** Chinese | सिन्धु लिपि / अस्थि लेख |
| Mahapurana | Upapurana | 18 major (5 traits) vs 18 **minor** | महापुराण / उपपुराण |
| Vishnu Purana | Vayu Purana | **Mauryan** list vs **not** Gupta admin | विष्णु / वायु |
| Matsya Purana | Vishnu Purana | Longest **Andhra / Satavahana** list vs **Mauryan** genealogy | मत्स्य / विष्णु |
| Ikshvaku | Vakataka | Puranic **Shriparvatiya** vs Vidarbha | इक्ष्वाकु / वाकाटक |
| Charvaka | Charaka | Materialist school vs **Ayurveda** compiler | चार्वाक / चरक |
| Charvaka | Buddhism | Denies rebirth vs accepts **karma/rebirth** | चार्वाक / बौद्ध |
| Kakatiya | Yadava | **Warangal** vs **Devagiri** | काकतीय / यादव |
| Warangal | Hanamkonda | Fort capital vs **Thousand Pillar** town | वारंगल / हनमकोंडा |
| Ganapati | Rudrama | Peak expander vs **queen** (his daughter) | गणपतिदेव / रुद्रमा |
| Rudrama | Prataparudra II | Female monarch vs **last** king, fall **1323** | रुद्रमा / प्रतापरुद्र |
| Ramappa | Thousand Pillar | Palampet **UNESCO 2021** vs Hanamkonda | रामप्पा / सहस्र स्तंभ |
| Jayaswal | Smith | *Hindu Polity* vs *Early History of India* | जयसवाल / स्मिथ |
| Kosambi | Basham | Marxist *Introduction* vs cultural *Wonder* | कोसांबी / बैशम |
| Charaka | Sushruta | Internal medicine **120/8** vs **surgery** | चरक / सुश्रुत |

## Books and Writers — Miscellaneous

| Book / text | Writer / authority | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| *Hindu Polity* | **K.P. Jayaswal** | Nationalist gana / polity reading |
| *The Wonder That Was India* | **A.L. Basham** | Cultural survey |
| *An Introduction to the Study of Indian History* | **D.D. Kosambi** | Marxist / analytical history |
| *The Early History of India* | **Vincent Arthur Smith** | Colonial dynastic narrative |
| *Charaka Samhita* | **Charaka** (चरक) (Agnivesha redaction) | Internal medicine; **120 chapters / 8 sthanas** |
| *Sushruta Samhita* (सुश्रुत संहिता) | **Sushruta** | Surgery / rhinoplasty tradition |

## 14.2 Civilizations and their Characteristics

| Trait | Mesopotamia | Egypt | Harappan | Shang |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| River | Tigris–Euphrates | Nile | Indus–Ghaggar | Yellow River |
| Polity | City-states → empires | Unified pharaoh | Urban centres, king unnamed | King + clans |
| Script | Cuneiform (**read**) | Hieroglyphs (**read**) | Indus (**unread**) | Oracle bones (**read**) |
| Monument | Ziggurat | Pyramid | Great Bath, granaries | Bronze ritual set |

| Trait | Mesopotamia | Egypt | Harappan | Shang |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Economy | Temple + long-distance trade | Nile grain | Agri + craft + Meluhha trade | Agri + bronze elite |
| Religion | Many gods, Enuma Elish | Divine king, afterlife | Unresolved (Pashupati debate) | Ancestors + Di |
| End-note | Conquest replacement | Dynastic continuity | De-urbanisation ~1900 BCE | Zhou conquest |

## 14.3 Puranas

| Mark | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Sarga** | Creation |
| **Pratisarga** | Dissolution / recreation |
| **Vamsha** | Gods-and-sages genealogy |
| **Manvantara** | Manu-ages / cosmic cycles |
| **Vamshanucharita** | Royal dynasties (the history bit) |

### 18 Mahapuranas (match list)

| # | Purana | Usual sect-tag |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Brahma | Brahma |
| 2 | Padma | Vishnu |
| 3 | **Vishnu** | Vishnu — **Mauryan list** |
| 4 | Shiva | Shiva |
| 5 | **Bhagavata** | Vishnu / Krishna bhakti |
| 6 | Narada | Vishnu |
| 7 | **Markandeya** | Devi Mahatmya sits here |
| 8 | Agni | Encyclopaedic (weapons, vastu) |
| 9 | Bhavishya | Mixed / later layers |
| 10 | Brahmavaivarta | Krishna |
| 11 | Linga | Shiva |
| 12 | Varaha | Vishnu |
| 13 | **Skanda** | Shiva — largest, tirtha-heavy |
| 14 | Vamana | Vishnu |
| 15 | Kurma | Vishnu |
| 16 | Matsya | Vishnu — flood + dynastic lists |
| 17 | **Garuda** | Vishnu — shraddha / afterlife |
| 18 | Brahmanda | Brahma |

### Purana → dynasty (history use)

| Purana | Dynasty it is asked for | What it preserves |
|---|---|---|
| **Vishnu Purana** (विष्णु पुराण) | **Maurya** (मौर्य) | Maurya genealogy. The same Magadha chain also names Nanda, Shunga, and Kanva. |
| **Matsya Purana** (मत्स्य पुराण) | **Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन) | Longest Andhra list, about **30** kings and about **460** years. |

| Purana | Dynasty it is asked for | What it preserves |
|---|---|---|
| **Vayu Purana** (वायु पुराण) | **Gupta** (गुप्त) *kings* | Gupta **names**. Also the Kanva end and Andhra founder **Simuka** (सिमुक). It is **not** a Gupta admin manual. |
| **Brahmanda Purana** (ब्रह्माण्ड पुराण) | Parallel to Vayu | Andhra and Gupta name-lists sit close to the Vayu recension. |
| **Bhagavata Purana** (भागवत पुराण) | Solar–lunar lines + Krishna | Also carries Maurya–Andhra lists. It is the Krishna-bhakti peak text. |
| **Bhavishya Purana** (भविष्य पुराण) | "Future" Kali-age kings | Later layers. Use it lightly. |
| **Markandeya Purana** (मार्कण्डेय पुराण) | Not a dynasty match | *Devi Mahatmya* (देवी माहात्म्य) sits here. |
| **Skanda Purana** (स्कन्द पुराण) | Not a dynasty match | Largest Maha. Tirtha geography, not the Magadha king-list. |

## 14.5 Kakatiya Dynasty

### Capital match

| Dynasty | Capital |
|---|---|
| Pallava | **Kanchi** (कांची) |
| Pandya | **Madura** (Madurai) |
| Yadava (Seuna) | **Devagiri** |
| Kakatiya | **Warangal** |

### Warangal name trap

- Pair **Warangal — Ramchandra Dev** is **NOT** correctly matched.
- **Ramachandra** is the **Yadava** king of **Devagiri** (the man Alauddin squeezed).
- Warangal's last Kakatiya is **Prataparudra**, not Ramachandra.

> **Logic:** Warangal in Alauddin's **conquest chronology** is a **Sultanate** question. The fact here is only: Deccan raid hits **Kakatiya Warangal** after the Rajput forts.

## Common Traps — Facts

1. **Vayu Purana = Gupta administration** → false. 2023 Q29 Only 1.
2. **Shriparvatiya = Vakataka → Ikshvaku** (Nagarjunakonda).
3. **Purana Qila = a Mahapurana** → Delhi **fort**.
4. **Harappan script = readable hieroglyphs** → still **unread**.
5. **Ziggurat = pyramid** → temple tower vs **tomb**.
6. **Kakatiya capital = Devagiri → Warangal**. Devagiri = Yadava.
7. **Warangal = Ramchandra Dev** → 2018 bait. Ramachandra = **Yadava**.
8. **Prataparudra founded Kakatiyas** → he is the **last** (1323).
9. **Rudrama = Chola / Hoysala → Kakatiya**, daughter of Ganapati.
10. **Thousand Pillar = Palampet / inside the fort → Hanamkonda**.
11. **Ramappa = Karnataka / Andhra → Telangana**, UNESCO **2021**.
12. **Charvaka wrote Charaka Samhita** → physician vs materialist.

13. **Charaka = 100 chapters / 5 sections → 120 / 8**.
14. **Kosambi wrote *Early History of India* → Smith**. Kosambi = *Introduction to the Study*.
15. **Basham = Marxist historian** → cultural survey. Marxist fact = **Kosambi**.
16. **Buddhism = Charvaka** → Buddhism keeps **rebirth**.
17. **Nyaya = Kanada** → Nyaya = **Gautama**. Kanada = Vaisheshika.
18. **Kakatiyas ruled the UP doab → Telangana**.
19. **Meluhha = Egypt** → Mesopotamia's name for the **Indus** land.
20. **Independent Kakatiyas till 1687** → end **1323**. 1687 is Golconda.

# Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Prehistoric & Protohistoric UK

## Quick Revision — Spine Only

| Head | Key Fact |
|---|---|
| **Lakhudiyar (Lakhu Cave)** | Barechhina, **Almora** (अल्मोड़ा) on the **Suyal river**; discovered 1968 by **Dr. M. P. Joshi**; red, black, white motifs |
| **Gwarkha Udyar** | Dungri village, **Chamoli** (चमोली) on **Alaknanda river**; discovered by Rakesh Bhatt; vivid red animal depictions |
| **Hudli Rock Art** | **Uttarkashi** (उत्तरकाशी) on Kamal river; unique for **blue colour** rock paintings |
| **Kimni Village** | Chamoli (Pindar valley); **light white colour** depictions of weapons and cattle |
| **Luethap** | Almora; human figures painted in **blood-red colour** in group dancing postures |
| **Falsima** | Almora; humans depicted in **yogic and dancing postures**; prehistoric cup-marks (*Okhal*) |
| **Phadkanauli & Petshal** | Almora; discovered by **Dr. Yashodhar Mathpal** (1989–90); ochre dance motifs |
| **Malari Excavations** | **Chamoli**; investigated by **S. P. Dabral (1956)** and **Garhwal University (1983, 2001)** |
| **Malari Master Finds** | **5.2 kg gold face mask**, complete skeleton of Himalayan Zebu bull, Swat-style pottery |
| **Bankot Copper Hoard** | **Pithoragarh** (पिथौरागढ़); **8 copper anthropomorphs** (humanoid figures) discovered in 1989 |
| **Bahadrabad (Haridwar)** | Excavated 1951–53 by **Y. D. Sharma**; Copper Hoards and Ochre-Coloured Pottery (OCP) |
| **Naula Jainal (Almora)** | Megalithic cist-burials discovered by Dr. M. P. Joshi |

## Master Table of Prehistoric Rock Art Sites in Uttarakhand

| Site Name | District & River Basin | Discovered By / Year | Distinguishing Visual & Stylistic Features |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Lakhudiyar (Lakhu Udyar)** | **Almora** (Barechhina, Suyal river) | **Dr. M. P. Joshi** (1968) | Largest rock shelter. 3 colours: red, black, white. Humans in interlocking finger dancing chain; lizard-like animals; wavy lines. |
| **Gwarkha Udyar** | **Chamoli** (Dungri village, Alaknanda) | Rakesh Bhatt | Vivid, well-preserved depictions of human hunters, sheep, mountain goats, and deer painted in bold ochre. |
| **Kimni Village** | **Chamoli** (Tharali, Pindar river) | State Archaeology Survey | Distinctive **light white chalk/lime** paintings depicting spears, daggers, bows, arrows, and livestock. |
| **Luethap** | **Almora** (near Almora town) | Regional Survey | Figures rendered in striking **blood-red colour**; depiction of humans driving animals into traps and hand-in-hand dance. |
| **Hudli** | **Uttarkashi** (Kamal river valley) | State Archaeology Survey | **Blue colour** rock inscriptions and geometric animal paintings (unique in the Central Himalaya). |
| **Falsima** | **Almora** (near Phadkanauli) | Regional Survey | Humans depicted in **Yogic postures** (*Asanas*) and ritual dance circles; cup-marks cut into rock slabs. |
| **Phadkanauli** | **Almora** (Barechhina-Danya road) | **Dr. Yashodhar Mathpal** (1989) | Three painted rock shelters with reddish-brown deer and human scenes. |
| **Petshal** | **Almora** (between Barechhina & Danya) | **Dr. Yashodhar Mathpal** (1990) | Ochre-coloured dancing human figures in ceremonial rows. |
| **Kasardevi Cave** | **Almora** (Crank's Ridge) | Prehistoric shelter | Cup-marks and prehistoric incisions; later site of Swami Vivekananda's meditation (1890). |

## Confused Pairs & Common Traps

| Confused Pair | Critical Distinction |
|---|---|
| **Lakhudiyar vs Gwarkha** | Lakhudiyar = **Almora (Suyal river)**, M. P. Joshi; Gwarkha = **Chamoli (Alaknanda river)**, Dungri village. |
| **Hudli vs Kimni** | Hudli = **blue colour** paintings (Uttarkashi); Kimni = **light white colour** paintings (Chamoli). |
| **Malari vs Burzahom** | Malari = **Chamoli** (gold mask, cist burial, Zebu bull); Burzahom = **Kashmir** (Neolithic pit-dwellings, dog burial). |
| **Bankot vs Bahadrabad** | Bankot = **Pithoragarh** (8 copper anthropomorphs); Bahadrabad = **Haridwar** (OCP and copper celts). |
| **Kalsi Ashokan Edict Language** | Language is **Prakrit**; script is **Brahmi** (trap: not Sanskrit or Kharoshthi). |

# Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Ancient Tribes

## Quick Revision — Spine Only

| Head | Key Fact |
|---|---|
| **Earliest Inhabitants** | **Kol (Munda)** — identified by Dr. S. P. Dabral; totemism, snake/linga worship |
| **Epic Himalayan Tribe** | **Kirat** — defeated Kols; Shiva tested Arjuna in Kirat guise at Bilvakedar; direct descendants: **Raji** |
| **Dominant Ancient Race** | **Khas** — entered via Central Asia/Kashmir; classified as degraded Kshatriyas in Manusmriti |
| **Khas Customary Laws** | **Ghar-Javai**, **Tekwa** (levirate/widow retaining companion), **Jethon** (extra share to eldest son) |
| **Shaka Presence Proof** | **Sun Temples** across Uttarakhand (**Katarmal Sun Temple** Almora, Palothi, Madh) |
| **ST Notification Year** | **1967** — Government of India notified **5 Scheduled Tribes** in Uttarakhand |
| **Largest ST by Population** | **Tharu** (Udham Singh Nagar: Khatima, Sitarganj); celebrate Diwali as **Shok Parva** (Mourning) |
| **2nd Largest ST** | **Jaunsari** (Dehradun: Chakrata, Kalsi, Tyuni); polyandry tradition; **Mahasu Devta** worship |
| **Trans-Himalayan Traders** | **Bhotia** (Johar, Darma, Byans, Niti, Mana); transhumance; ancient Indo-Tibetan barter trade |
| **Smallest ST Population** | **Raji (Van Rawat / Jungle Kings)** of Pithoragarh; cave dwellings (*Rauthiyada*); **silent trade** |
| **Terai Tribe** | **Buksa (Bhoksa)** of Buksad (Bazpur, Kashipur, Ramnagar); claim descent from **Mewar Rajputs** |

## Modern Scheduled Tribes of Uttarakhand (Notified 1967)

| Scheduled Tribe | Primary Concentration | Cultural & Religious Hallmarks | High-Yield Prelims Hooks |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tharu** | Udham Singh Nagar (Khatima, Sitarganj, Kichha) | Matriarchal influence (women hold supreme domestic authority). Worship *Khadga Bhoot*, *Pachhim-Rukh*. Celebrate *Bajhar* festival. | **Largest ST** in UK (~33% of tribal pop). Celebrate **Diwali as Shok Parva** (Mourning). Traditional alcoholic beverage: **Jand**. |
| **Jaunsari** | Dehradun (Chakrata, Kalsi, Tyuni / Jaunsar-Bawar) | Polyandry (*Draupadi Vivah*, fraternal polyandry). Supreme deity: **Mahasu Devta** (Hanol Temple on Tons river). | **2nd Largest ST** in UK. Festivals: **Bissu** (Baisakhi), **Magh Mela** (animal sacrifice / Maroj). Folk dances: **Barada Nati** (बरदा नाटी), Harul, Thandya. |
| **Bhotia** | Chamoli, Pithoragarh, Uttarkashi | Mongoloid descent. Divided into sub-groups: **Johari, Darmiya, Byansi, Chaudansi, Tolchha, Marchha, Jad**. High-altitude transhumance. | Ancient Trans-Himalayan wool & salt trade with Western Tibet (*Huniyas*) terminated after 1962 Sino-Indian War. Traditional drink: **Chhang**. Winter home: *Gunda/Munsa*; Summer home: *Mait*. |
| **Buksa (Bhoksa)** | US Nagar (Bazpur, Kashipur), Dehradun, Nainital (*Buksad* belt) | Claim royal descent from **Udaipur/Mewar Rajputs** who fled after Mughal invasions. Worship **Chamunda Devi** (Chaiti Mela at Kashipur). | Patriarchal families; Council head called **Takhat** assisted by *Munsif* (मुंसिफ़) and *Daroga*. |
| **Raji (Van Rawat)** | Pithoragarh (Didihat, Dharchula, Champawat fringe) | Traditionally nomadic cave dwellers (*Rauthiyada*); worship *Nandadevi*, *Ghananad*, and forest spirits. | **Smallest ST** in UK (< 1,000 persons). Historically practiced **Silent Barter Trade (Mook Vyapar)**. Language: **Tibo-Burman / Munda dialect**. |

## Confused Pairs & Common Traps

| Confused Pair | Critical Distinction |
|---|---|
| **Tharu vs Buksa** | Tharu = **Largest ST** (matriarchal lean, Diwali as mourning); Buksa = **Udaipur Rajput descent**, Chaiti Mela at Kashipur. |

| Confused Pair | Critical Distinction |
|---|---|
| **Marchha / Tolchha vs Jad** | Marchha & Tolchha = Bhotia sub-clans in **Chamoli (Niti/Mana)**; Jad = Bhotia sub-clan in **Uttarkashi (Jadhung/Nelang)** practicing Buddhism. |
| **Hanol Temple vs Katarmal Temple** | Hanol (Tons river) = Supreme shrine of **Mahasu Devta (Jaunsari)**; Katarmal (Almora) = 9th-century **Sun Temple (Shaka influence)**. |
| **Raji vs Tharu Population** | Tharu is the **most numerous** ST (~33%); Raji is the **least numerous** ST (< 1%). |
| **Bissu vs Baisakhi** | Bissu is the **Jaunsari festival** celebrated on Baisakhi featuring traditional archery (*Thoda*) dance. |

# Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Kuninda & Yaudheya

## Quick Revision — Spine Only

| Head | Key Fact |
|---|---|
| **First Historic Dynasty** | **Kuninda (Kulinda)** — ruled central Himalayan foothills from **2nd cent. BCE to 3rd cent. CE** |
| **Epic Identity** | Mentioned in Mahabharata; King **Subahu** of Subahupur (Srinagar); hailed as **Dwij Srestha** |
| **Greatest Monarch** | **Amoghbhuti** (1st century BCE) — issued bi-scriptural silver and copper coinage |
| **Amoghbhuti Coins** | Obverse: **Brahmi**; Reverse: **Kharoshthi** (खरोष्ठी); motifs: Goddess Lakshmi, deer, tree in railing |
| **Almora Type Coins** | 8 rulers: **Shivdatt, Shivpalit, Haridatt, Gomitra, Aashadh, Mrigbhuti, Vijayabhuti** |
| **Chhatreshwar Type Coins** | Dedicated to **Lord Shiva (Chhatreshwar)** holding trident; legend: *Bhagavata Chhatreshwara* |
| **Yaudheya Republic** | Martial *Ayudhajivi Gana*; coin hoards found at **Jaunsar-Bawar, Bhadraj, and Lansdowne** |
| **Yaudheya Coin Motifs** | **Lord Karttikeya** (with peacock) and Goddess Devsena; legend: *"Yaudheya Ganasya Jaya"* |
| **Brahmapura Kingdom** | 6th–7th cent. kingdom recorded by Hiuen Tsang; ruled by **Paurava / Vrishavardhan dynasty** |
| **Taleshwar Copper Plates** | Found in **Almora** (अल्मोड़ा); record grants of Paurava kings (Dvijavardhan, Vishnuvardhan) to God Biraneswar |

## Confused Pairs & Common Traps

| Confused Pair | Critical Distinction |
|---|---|
| **Amoghbhuti vs Chhatreshwar** | Amoghbhuti = **personal king's name** (silver + copper); Chhatreshwar = **religious dedication to Lord Shiva** (copper). |
| **Almora Type vs Amoghbhuti Type** | Almora type = **Brahmi only** (8 local king names); Amoghbhuti type = **bi-scriptural** (Brahmi + Kharoshthi). |
| **Brahmapura vs Kartikeyapur** | Brahmapura = **6th–7th century kingdom** (Taleshwar plates, Hiuen Tsang); Kartikeyapur = **8th–11th century Katyuri capital** (Baijnath). |
| **Yaudheya vs Kuninda** | Yaudheya = warrior **gana / republic** (Karttikeya); Kuninda = foothill **monarchical/tribal state** (Lakshmi & deer). |
| **Taleshwar vs Pandukeshwar** | Taleshwar (Almora) = **Paurava dynasty plates**; Pandukeshwar (Chamoli) = **Katyuri dynasty plates**. |

# Uttarakhand — Topic 4 — Kartikepur Dynasty

## Quick Revision — Spine Only

| Head | Key Fact |
|---|---|
| **Dynasty Name** | **Kartikepur / Katyuri** — first historic imperial kingdom of Uttarakhand (c. **740 CE to 1050 CE**) |
| **First Capital** | **Joshimath (Kartikeyapura)** in the Alaknanda valley (Garhwal) |
| **Second Capital** | **Baijnath (Katyur Valley)** on the Gomti river in Bageshwar (Kumaon) |
| **Founder Tradition** | **Basantandev (Basu Dev)** — assumed title *Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja* |
| **Primary Epigraphic Record** | **Bageshwar Inscription** of King Bhuwandev & **4 Pandukeshwar Copper Plates** |
| **The Great Unifier** | **Ishtaganadeva** — first monarch to politically unify entire Garhwal and Kumaon |
| **Most Powerful Monarch** | **Lalitsuradeva** — compared to Varaha and Bhagiratha in Pandukeshwar plates |
| **Three Dynastic Houses** | 1. **Basantandev House** \rightarrow 2. **Nimbar House** \rightarrow 3. **Salonaditya House** |
| **Tyrannical Last King** | **Bir Dev (Biram Dev)** — notoriously tyrannical; overthrown by local uprising |
| **Post-Katyuri Branches** | Fragmented into **Askot (Rajbars), Doti (Raiykas), Dwarahat, and Baijnath** |
| **Official Language & Script** | Official/epigraphic language: **Sanskrit**; Script: **Kutila / Siddhamatrika** |

## The Three Dynastic Families of the Katyuris

### Detailed Ruler Matrix & Achievements

| Dynastic House | Rulers | High-Yield Prelims Milestones |
|---|---|---|
| **First Family** *(House of Basantandev)* | **Basantandev** (Founder), Kharparadeva, Kalyanrajadeva, Tribhuwanrajadeva | Basantandev founded the house around 740 CE. Mentioned in Bageshwar stone inscription as donating *Swarnakeshwar* village to a temple. Tribhuwanrajadeva made grants to God Vyaghreswar. |
| **Second Family** *(House of Nimbar)* | **Nimbar**, **Ishtaganadeva**, **Lalitsuradeva**, **Bhuwandev** | **Nimbar:** Zealous devotee of Shiva; built rock-cut shrines.<br>**Ishtaganadeva:** Succeeded Nimbar; **unified entire Uttarakhand** (Kumaon and Garhwal); built Lakuli-Shiva and Navadurga temples.<br>**Lalitsuradeva:** Son of Ishtaganadeva and Queen Vegadevi; 44-year reign; issued 2 Pandukeshwar plates.<br>**Bhuwandev:** Endowed Bageshwar temple with revenues of several villages. |
| **Third Family** *(House of Salonaditya)* | Salonaditya, **Ichhata Deva**, Deshatadeva, **Padmata**, **Subhiksharaja** | Succeeded after civil strife. Replaced the capital at *Subhikshapura*. Inscribed Pandukeshwar copper plates dating to early 11th century. |

## Administrative Matrix & Official Hierarchy of the Katyuris

| Sanskrit Official Title | Exact Portfolio / Administrative Function |
|---|---|
| **Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja** | Supreme title assumed by the Katyuri Sovereign. |
| **Mahasamanta** (महासामंत) | Semi-autonomous feudatory prince or chief commander. |
| **Kottapala** | Military commandant in charge of frontier forts and mountain passes. |
| **Doshaparadhika** | High-level investigative officer responsible for apprehending thieves, rebels, and felons. |
| **Dandapashika / Dandanayaka** | Criminal magistrate and executioner enforcing penal justice. |
| **Bhogika / Mahabhogika** | High revenue officer responsible for collecting the king's share of grain and cattle (*Bhoga*). |

| Sanskrit Official Title | Exact Portfolio / Administrative Function |
|---|---|
| **Saulkika** | Toll and customs collection officer positioned along mountain transit points. |
| **Tarika / Ghattapala** | Officer supervising river ferries, boats, and bridge crossings. |
| **Khadgika** | Royal personal bodyguard armed with the royal sword. |
| **Pratihara / Mahapratihara** | Chief Palace Chamberlain regulating entry into the royal presence. |
| **Kishorvadhabhikrit** | Officer looking after royal mares, horses, and studs. |

## Confused Pairs & Common Traps

| Confused Pair | Critical Distinction |
|---|---|
| **Kartikeyapura vs Brahmapura** | Kartikeyapura = **Katyuri capital** (Joshimath \rightarrow Baijnath); Brahmapura = **6th–7th century regional entity** in Hiuen Tsang / Taleshwar plates. |
| **Basantandev vs Ishtaganadeva** | Basantandev = **Founder** of Katyuri state; Ishtaganadeva = **Unifier** of both Garhwal and Kumaon. |
| **Bageshwar Inscription vs Pandukeshwar Plates** | Bageshwar = **Stone inscription of Bhuwandev**; Pandukeshwar = **4 Copper plates** (Lalitsuradeva, Padmata, Subhiksharajadeva). |
| **Bir Dev vs Somchand** | Bir Dev = **Last tyrannical Katyuri king**; Somchand = **Founder of Chand dynasty** who succeeded the Katyuris in Kali Kumaon. |
| **Doshaparadhika vs Dandapashika** | Doshaparadhika = **Investigative officer** (detective); Dandapashika = **Penal enforcer** (punishment magistrate). |